BIRDS OF KENYA · TAXONOMY REVIEW

Taxonomy changes

Birds of Kenya, 2019.1 to 2026.0

Taxonomically ordered comparison of historical and current concepts

380 change groups

Struthioniformes

Ostriches Struthionidae

2019.1		2026.0
Common Ostrich *Struthio camelus (race camelus)* avibase-2247CB05	1:1 →	**Common Ostrich** *Struthio camelus* avibase-2247CB05

Anseriformes

Ducks, Swans, and Geese Anatidae

2019.1		2026.0
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Cotton Pygmy Goose** *Nettapus coromandelianus* avibase-90AAE188

2019.1		2026.0
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Ruddy Shelduck** *Tadorna ferruginea* avibase-1F9D883E

2019.1		2026.0
Hottentot Teal *Spatula hottentota* avibase-FA831F65	1:1 →	**Blue-billed Teal** *Spatula hottentota* avibase-FA831F65

2019.1		2026.0
Eurasian Teal *Anas crecca* avibase-BC6C3CCE	1:1 →	**Green-winged Teal** *Anas crecca* avibase-BC6C3CCE

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon carolinensis is treated as a subspecies of Anas crecca based on high levels of introgression, coupled with a lack of known differences in courtship vocalization. Although mitochondrial DNA data show a relatively deep divergence between these taxa (Peters et al. 2012), a lack of genomic divergence (McLaughlin et al. 2020; Spaulding et al. 2023) indicates that male-mediated gene flow is extensive.

Galliformes

Guineafowl Numididae

2019.1		2026.0
Crested Guineafowl *Guttera pucherani* avibase-D5813CA4 **Kenya Crested Guineafowl** *Guttera pucherani pucherani* avibase-35D60F12 **Crested Guineafowl** *Guttera (pucherani) verreauxi* avibase-9D29C252	n:n →	**Eastern Crested Guineafowl** *Guttera pucherani* avibase-35D60F12 **Western Crested Guineafowl** *Guttera verreauxi* avibase-9D29C252

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxa edouardi (polytypic, including barbata) and verreauxi (polytypic) are treated as species separate from Guttera pucherani (monotypic) based on differences in plumage, eye color, and bare parts color. However, further research is needed including investigation of potential hybrid zones and formal bioacoustic analysis. Genetic data would also be informative.

Partridges, Pheasants, Grouse, and Allies Phasianidae

2019.1		2026.0
Coqui Francolin *Peliperdix coqui* avibase-ECD7C1D8	1:1 →	**Coqui Francolin** *Campocolinus coqui* avibase-ECD7C1D8

2019.1
Elgon Francolin *Scleroptila elgonensis (race theresae)* avibase-3D25568A

1:1 →

2026.0
Elgon Francolin *Scleroptila elgonensis* avibase-3D25568A

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon elgonensis is treated as a monotypic species separate from Scleroptila psilolaema (monotypic) based on plumage, vocalizations, and genetics (Hunter et al. 2019; Turner et al. 2020).

2019.1
Archer’s Francolin *Scleroptila gutturalis* avibase-8E833C63

1:1 →

2026.0
Orange River Francolin *Scleroptila gutturalis* avibase-8E833C63

2019.1
Shelley's Francolin *Scleroptila shelleyi (race macarthuri)* avibase-A15F6836

1:1 →

2026.0
Shelley's Francolin *Scleroptila shelleyi* avibase-A15F6836

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon whytei is split from Scleroptila shelleyi based on plumage and genetics. Mitochondrial DNA data (Mandiwana-Neudani et al. 2019) indicate species-level divergence between these taxa but intra-generic relationships remain poorly resolved (Mandiwana-Neudani et al. 2019; Kimball et al. 2021).

2019.1
Crested Francolin *Dendroperdix sephaena* avibase-8004C7E5

1:1 →

2026.0
Crested Francolin *Ortygornis sephaena* avibase-8004C7E5

2019.1
African Blue Quail *Synoicus adansoniee* avibase-CAA45AC6

1:1 →

2026.0
Blue Quail *Synoicus adansonii* avibase-CAA45AC6

2019.1
Common Quail *Coturnix coturnix (race coturnix)* avibase-CAFE345D

1:1 →

2026.0
Common Quail *Coturnix coturnix* avibase-CAFE345D

2019.1
Chestnut-naped Francolin *Pternistis castaneicollis (race atrifrons)* avibase-81474844

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-naped Spurfowl *Pternistis castaneicollis* avibase-81474844

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon atrifrons is treated as conspecific with Pternistis castaneicollis based on available evidence. Divergence in mitochondrial DNA and phenotypic traits (Töpfer et al. 2014) is more consistent with subspecies status in francolins (Bloomer & Crowe 1998).

2019.1
Jackson’s Francolin *Pternistis jacksoni* avibase-A7E59764

1:1 →

2026.0
Jackson's Spurfowl *Pternistis jacksoni* avibase-A7E59764

2019.1
Hildebrandt's Francolin *Pternistis hildebrandti* avibase-F5A73AAA

1:1 →

2026.0
Hildebrandt's Spurfowl *Pternistis hildebrandti* avibase-F5A73AAA

2019.1
Scaly Francolin *Pternistis squamatus* avibase-1B11690B

1:1 →

2026.0
Scaly Spurfowl *Pternistis squamatus* avibase-1B11690B

Musophagiformes

Turacos Musophagidae

2019.1
Bare-faced Go-away-bird *Corythaixoides personatus* avibase-215428B0
Bare-faced (Brown-faced) Go-away-bird *Corythaixoides personatus personatus* avibase-71A552DA
Bare-faced (Black-faced) Go-away-bird *Corythaixoides (personatus) leopoldi* avibase-BEDA5DA6

n:1 →

2026.0
Bare-faced Go-away-bird *Crinifer personatus* avibase-215428B0

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon leopoldi (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Crinifer personatus, as plumage differences are modest and variable within each taxon, and no behavioral or ecological differences have been identified; genetic data would be informative.

2019.1
White-bellied Go-away-bird *Criniferoides leucogaster* avibase-2AA4BC58

1:1 →

2026.0
White-bellied Go-away-bird *Crinifer leucogaster* avibase-2AA4BC58

AviList taxonomy decision

Corythaixoides and Criniferoides are placed in the genus Crinifer based on a combination of nuclear and mitochondrial DNA data (Veron & Winney 2000; Njabo & Sorenson 2009; Perktaş et al. 2020).

2019.1
Eastern Grey Plantain-eater *Crinifer zonurus* avibase-10B14696

1:1 →

2026.0
Eastern Plantain-eater *Crinifer zonurus* avibase-10B14696

AviList taxonomy decision

Corythaixoides and Criniferoides are placed in the genus Crinifer based on a combination of nuclear and mitochondrial DNA data (Veron & Winney 2000; Njabo & Sorenson 2009; Perktaş et al. 2020).

2019.1
Ross's Turaco *Musophaga rossae* avibase-2C7BA3A6

1:1 →

2026.0
Ross's Turaco *Tauraco rossae* avibase-2C7BA3A6

2019.1
Schalow's Turaco *Tauraco Schalowi* avibase-22952180

1:1 →

2026.0
Schalow's Turaco *Tauraco schalowi* avibase-22952180

Otidiformes

Bustards Otididae

2019.1
Denham’s Bustard *Ardeotis denhami* avibase-4FDBC0CB

1:1 →

2026.0
Denham's Bustard *Neotis denhami* avibase-4FDBC0CB

2019.1
Heuglin’s Bustard *Ardeotis heuglinii* avibase-4971D1EF

1:1 →

2026.0
Heuglin's Bustard *Neotis heuglinii* avibase-4971D1EF

Cuculiformes

Cuckoos Cuculidae

2019.1		2026.0
White-browed Coucal *Centropus superciliosus* avibase-BD2BC35C	1:1 →	**White-browed Coucal** *Centropus superciliosus* avibase-4B2A7A35

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon burchellii (polytypic, including fasciipygialis) is treated as a species separate from Centropus superciliosus based on plumage differences, supported by limited hybridization in areas of contact (Harrison et al. 1997). However, ecological and vocal differences have not been documented, suggesting further research is warranted.

2019.1		2026.0
Southern Yellowbill (Green Malkoha) *Ceuthmochares australis* avibase-3A46A20C	1:1 →	**Green Malkoha** *Ceuthmochares australis* avibase-3A46A20C

2019.1		2026.0
Western Yellowbill (Blue Malkoha) *Ceuthmochares aereus* avibase-E0D521B7	1:1 →	**Blue Malkoha** *Ceuthmochares aereus* avibase-E0D521B7

Columbiformes

Doves and Pigeons Columbidae

2019.1		2026.0
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Vinaceous Dove** *Streptopelia vinacea* avibase-DDEF7228

2019.1		2026.0
African Mourning Dove *Streptopelia decipiens* avibase-70BD722B	1:1 →	**Mourning Collared Dove** *Streptopelia decipiens* avibase-70BD722B

2019.1		2026.0
African White-winged Dove *Streptopelia reichenowi* avibase-65FE8029	1:1 →	**White-winged Collared Dove** *Streptopelia reichenowi* avibase-65FE8029

2019.1		2026.0
Feral Pigeon *Columba livia* avibase-BBA263C2	1:1 →	**Rock Dove** *Columba livia* avibase-BBA263C2

2019.1		2026.0
Blue-spotted Wood-Dove *Turtur afer* avibase-23D5FC36	1:1 →	**Blue-spotted Wood Dove** *Turtur afer* avibase-23D5FC36

2019.1		2026.0
Emerald-spotted Wood-Dove *Turtur chalcospilos* avibase-BDF442F2	1:1 →	**Emerald-spotted Wood Dove** *Turtur chalcospilos* avibase-BDF442F2

Gruiformes

Cranes Gruidae

2019.1
Demoiselle Crane *Anthropoides virgo* avibase-64DDD14D

1:1 →

2026.0
Demoiselle Crane *Grus virgo* avibase-64DDD14D

AviList taxonomy decision

Anthropoides (polytypic) and Bugeranus (monotypic) are placed in the genus Grus based on available evidence. Analysis of complete mitochondrial genomes (Krajewski et al. 2010), and multilocus DNA data (Fain et al. 2007) failed to resolve basal relationships among these genera, indicating that they are best retained in an expanded Grus pending further research.

Rails, Gallinules, and Coots Rallidae

2019.1
African Water Rail *Rallus caerulescens* avibase-5B443EDE

1:1 →

2026.0
African Rail *Rallus caerulescens* avibase-5B443EDE

2019.1
African Crake *Crex egregia* avibase-09A0F2EB

1:1 →

2026.0
African Crake *Crecopsis egregia* avibase-09A0F2EB

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon egregia is placed in the monotypic genus Crecopsis based on nuclear and genomic DNA evidence of non-monophyly with Crex crex (Garcia-R et al. 2020; Kirchman et al. 2021).

2019.1
Corncrake *Crex crex* avibase-7E257242

1:1 →

2026.0
Corn Crake *Crex crex* avibase-7E257242

2019.1
Lesser Moorhen *Gallinula angulata* avibase-A927C1AE

1:1 →

2026.0
Lesser Moorhen *Paragallinula angulata* avibase-A927C1AE

2019.1
Purple Swamphen *Porphyrio porphyrio (race madagascariensis)* avibase-865C039E

1:1 →

2026.0
Purple Swamphen *Porphyrio porphyrio* avibase-AC1E791E

AviList taxonomy decision

The Porphyrio porphyrio complex is treated as a single polytypic species pending further research. Sometimes treated as six species based largely on mitochondrial-dominated DNA data (Sangster 1998; Garcia-R & Trewick 2015; Verry et al. 2023) that indicate deep divergences and paraphyly with respect to the two species of takahe, P. mantelli and P. hochstetteri. Available nuclear DNA data (Garcia-R & Trewick 2015) are mostly uninformative and mtDNA divergence times may be over-estimated. Further research incorporating denser sampling of nuclear DNA will be needed to determine species limits in this complex.

2019.1
Striped Crake *Amaurornis marginalis* avibase-13967506

1:1 →

2026.0
Striped Crake *Aenigmatolimnas marginalis* avibase-13967506

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon marginalis is placed in the genus Aenigmatolimnas based on nuclear (Garcia-R et al. 2020) and genomic DNA (Kirchman et al. 2021) evidence. Formerly placed in Amaurornis, deep divergence combined with differences in morphology, ecology, and biogeography indicate that marginalis is best treated as a monotypic genus.

Charadriiformes

Thick-knees and Stone-curlews Burhinidae

2019.1
Stone-curlew *Burhinus oedicnemus* avibase-C7DB323E

1:1 →

2026.0
Eurasian Stone-curlew *Burhinus oedicnemus* avibase-C7DB323E

Plovers and Lapwings Charadriidae

2019.1
Three-banded Plover *Charadrius tricollaris* avibase-8DAF86A1

1:1 →

2026.0
Three-banded Plover *Thinornis tricollaris* avibase-8DAF86A1

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon bifrontatus is treated as a subspecies of Thinornis tricollaris based on available evidence. Although the two taxa differ in plumage and mitochondrial DNA (Dos Remedios et al. 2020) the levels are more consistent with subspecific differentiation. A more comprehensive analysis based on genomic DNA may be informative.

2019.1
Little Ringed Plover *Charadrius dubius* avibase-35EC3BBF

1:1 →

2026.0
Little Ringed Plover *Thinornis dubius* avibase-35EC3BBF

2019.1
Long-toed Plover *Vanellus crassirostris* avibase-F7D5320E

1:1 →

2026.0
Long-toed Lapwing *Vanellus crassirostris* avibase-F7D5320E

2019.1
Blacksmith Plover *Vanellus armatus* avibase-2F23EDC6

1:1 →

2026.0
Blacksmith Lapwing *Vanellus armatus* avibase-2F23EDC6

2019.1
Spur-winged Plover *Vanellus spinosus* avibase-F5E92B22

1:1 →

2026.0
Spur-winged Lapwing *Vanellus spinosus* avibase-F5E92B22

2019.1
Black-headed Plover *Vanellus tectus* avibase-D531B5D3

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-headed Lapwing *Vanellus tectus* avibase-D531B5D3

2019.1
Senegal Plover *Vanellus lugubris* avibase-42D3918F

1:1 →

2026.0
Senegal Lapwing *Vanellus lugubris* avibase-42D3918F

2019.1
Black-winged Plover *Vanellus melanopterus* avibase-83D95620

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-winged Lapwing *Vanellus melanopterus* avibase-83D95620

2019.1
Crowned Plover *Vanellus coronatus* avibase-D0FA8EBE

1:1 →

2026.0
Crowned Lapwing *Vanellus coronatus* avibase-D0FA8EBE

2019.1
African Wattled Plover *Vanellus senegallus* avibase-074251A3

1:1 →

2026.0
African Wattled Lapwing *Vanellus senegallus* avibase-074251A3

2019.1
Brown-chested Plover *Vanellus superciliosus*
avibase-881C954D

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown-chested Lapwing *Vanellus superciliosus*
avibase-881C954D

2019.1
Caspian Plover *Charadrius asiaticus* avibase-264D0351

1:1 →

2026.0
Caspian Plover *Anarhynchus asiaticus* avibase-264D0351

2019.1
Lesser Sand Plover *Charadrius mongolus*
avibase-66DA1FB3

1:1 →

2026.0
Tibetan Sand Plover *Anarhynchus atrifrons*
avibase-828D3D5A

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon atrifrons (polytypic, including pamirensis and schaeferi) is treated as a species separate from Anarhynchus mongolus based on genomic DNA data, supported by vocalizations (Wei et al. 2022a).

2019.1
Greater Sand Plover *Charadrius leschenaultii*
avibase-98B9C10B

1:1 →

2026.0
Greater Sand Plover *Anarhynchus leschenaultii*
avibase-98B9C10B

2019.1
Kittlitz’s Plover *Charadrius pecuarius* avibase-0F0DCC2F

1:1 →

2026.0
Kittlitz's Plover *Anarhynchus pecuarius* avibase-0F0DCC2F

2019.1
Chestnut-banded Plover *Charadrius pallidus (race venustus)* avibase-61F0E581

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-banded Plover *Anarhynchus pallidus*
avibase-61F0E581

2019.1
White-fronted Plover *Charadrius marginatus*
avibase-214B3533

1:1 →

2026.0
White-fronted Plover *Anarhynchus marginatus*
avibase-214B3533

2019.1
Kentish Plover *Charadrius alexandrinus* avibase-AA4385A2

1:1 →

2026.0
Kentish Plover *Anarhynchus alexandrinus* avibase-AA4385A2

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon seebohmi is treated as a subspecies of Anarhynchus alexandrinus, as the evidentiary basis for a split is weak. Vocal differences between seebohmi and alexandrinus have not been documented; there are only minor morphometric differences between the two (Niroshan et al. 2023), for which clinal variation has not been ruled out; mitochondrial DNA divergence is negligible, and there is no support for seebohmi as the earliest-diverged lineage in this complex (Niroshan et al. 2023).

Sandpipers and Allies Scolopacidae

2019.1
Whimbrel *Numenius phaeopus* avibase-F9305BAA

1:1 →

2026.0
Eurasian Whimbrel *Numenius phaeopus*
avibase-082F3A63

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon hudsonicus (polytypic, including rufiventris) is treated as a species separate from Numenius phaeopus based on morphology and deep genomic DNA divergence (McLaughlin et al. 2020; Tan et al. 2023). However, vocalizations seem similar, and a formal bioacoustic analysis is lacking.

2019.1
Pintail Snipe *Gallinago stenura* avibase-EE61E2CA

1:1

2026.0
Pin-tailed Snipe *Gallinago stenura* avibase-EE61E2CA

→

2019.1
Grey Phalarope *Phalaropus fulicarius* avibase-18A19380

1:1 →

2026.0
Red Phalarope *Phalaropus fulicarius* avibase-18A19380

Buttonquail Turnicidae

2019.1
Black-rumped Buttonquail *Turnix hottentottus* avibase-0874B4D5

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-rumped Buttonquail *Turnix nanus* avibase-0874B4D5

Coursers and Pratincoles Glareolidae

2019.1
Double-banded Courser *Rhinoptilus africanus* avibase-C130193B

1:1 →

2026.0
Double-banded Courser *Smutsornis africanus* avibase-C130193B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon africanus is placed in the monotypic genus Smutsornis based on multilocus DNA data (Černý & Natale 2022), supported by differences in behavior, downy chick patterning, and syringeal structure (Brown & Ward 1990).

2019.1
Heuglin's Courser *Rhinoptilus cinctus* avibase-29D50ED5

1:1 →

2026.0
Three-banded Courser *Rhinoptilus cinctus* avibase-29D50ED5

2019.1
Cream-coloured Courser *Cursorius cursor* avibase-DE0A72A7

1:1 →

2026.0
Cream-colored Courser *Cursorius cursor* avibase-DE0A72A7

Jaegers and Skuas Stercorariidae

2019.1
Arctic Skua *Stercorarius parasiticus* avibase-39086887

1:1 →

2026.0
Parasitic Jaeger *Stercorarius parasiticus* avibase-39086887

2019.1
Long-tailed Skua *Stercorarius longicaudus* avibase-1D446440

1:1 →

2026.0
Long-tailed Jaeger *Stercorarius longicaudus* avibase-1D446440

2019.1
Pomarine Skua *Stercorarius pomarinus* avibase-7CB8F5B7

1:1 →

2026.0
Pomarine Jaeger *Stercorarius pomarinus* avibase-7CB8F5B7

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Brown Skua *Stercorarius antarcticus* avibase-4D5D2BC3

Skimmers, Noddies, Terns, and Gulls Laridae

2019.1		2026.0
Little Tern *Sternula albifrons* avibase-943CDEAC **Little Tern** *Sternula (albifrons) albifrons* avibase-17310BF0 **Saunders's Tern** *Sternula (albifrons) saundersi* avibase-4B21F4D8	n:1 →	**Little Tern** *Sternula albifrons* avibase-17310BF0
White-winged Black Tern *Chlidonias leucopterus* avibase-43CAAEE3	1:1 →	**White-winged Tern** *Chlidonias leucopterus* avibase-43CAAEE3
Greater Crested (Swift) Tern *Thalasseus bergii* avibase-526978C4	1:1 →	**Greater Crested Tern** *Thalasseus bergii* avibase-526978C4
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Little Gull** *Hydrocoloeus minutus* avibase-F89FD6E3
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Sabine's Gull** *Xema sabini* avibase-86182656
Common Gull *Larus canus* avibase-00DA9D91	Discontinued Pending EARC →	*None listed*
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Caspian Gull** *Larus cachinnans* avibase-93CA037F
Lesser Black-backed Gull *Larus fuscus* avibase-2D52E3A5 **Baltic Gull** *Larus fuscus fuscus* avibase-42720061 **Heuglin's Gull** *Larus (fuscus) heuglini* avibase-4592C07E	n:1 →	**Lesser Black-backed Gull** *Larus fuscus* avibase-2D52E3A5

Phaethontiformes

Tropicbirds Phaethontidae

2019.1		2026.0
None listed	New Pending EARC	**Red-billed Tropicbird** *Phaethon aethereus* avibase-7EE005BD

→

2019.1
None listed

New

Pending EARC

2026.0
Red-tailed Tropicbird *Phaethon rubricauda* avibase-C412CD62

→

Procellariiformes

Southern Storm Petrels Oceanitidae

2019.1
Wilson’s Storm-petrel *Oceanites oceanicus* avibase-D295D249

1:1 →

2026.0
Wilson's Storm Petrel *Oceanites oceanicus* avibase-D295D249

2019.1
Black-bellied Storm-Petrel *Fregetta tropica* avibase-ACE8EADE

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-bellied Storm Petrel *Fregetta tropica* avibase-ACE8EADE

Northern Storm Petrels Hydrobatidae

2019.1
Leach’s Storm-petrel *Hydrobates leucorhous* avibase-C5FB15C6

1:1 →

2026.0
Leach's Storm Petrel *Hydrobates leucorhous* avibase-C5FB15C6

Petrels, Shearwaters, and Diving Petrels Procellariidae

2019.1
Cape Petrel *Daption capense* avibase-AAC2D613

1:1 →

2026.0
Pintado Petrel *Daption capense* avibase-AAC2D613

2019.1
Tropical Shearwater *Puffinus bailloni* avibase-6DA05B66

1:1 →

2026.0
Persian Shearwater *Puffinus persicus* avibase-198120BB

Ciconiiformes

Storks Ciconiidae

2019.1
African Open-billed Stork *Anastomus lamelligerus* avibase-0F14ECE4

1:1 →

2026.0
African Openbill *Anastomus lamelligerus* avibase-0F14ECE4

2019.1
Woolly-necked Stork *Ciconia episcopus* avibase-F76E7B80

1:1 →

2026.0
African Woolly-necked Stork *Ciconia microscelis* avibase-5157C558

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon microscelis (monotypic) is treated as a species separate from Ciconia episcopus (polytypic) based on consistent differences in morphology (including plumage) and biogeographic considerations, the taxa being allopatric on separate continents.

Suliformes

Frigatebirds Fregatidae

2019.1
Christmas Island Frigatebird *Fregata andrewsi*
avibase-67200E8E

Discontinued

Pending EARC

→

2026.0
None listed

Boobies and Gannets Sulidae

2019.1
Brown Booby *Sula leucogaster* avibase-5EC21767

1:1

→

2026.0
Brown Booby *Sula leucogaster* avibase-05520B42

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon brewsteri (polytypic, including etesiaca) is treated as a species separate from Sula leucogaster based on differences in plumage, soft part colors, and behavior, including mostly assortative mating in sympatry (VanderWerf et al. 2023), combined with mitochondrial DNA divergence (Morris-Pocock et al. 2011).

Cormorants and Shags Phalacrocoracidae

2019.1
Long-tailed (Reed) Cormorant *Microcarbo africanus*
avibase-E255DCE1

1:1

→

2026.0
Reed Cormorant *Microcarbo africanus* avibase-E255DCE1

Pelecaniformes

Ibises and Spoonbills Threskiornithidae

2019.1
Sacred Ibis *Threskiornis aethiopicus* avibase-550DE745

1:1

→

2026.0
African Sacred Ibis *Threskiornis aethiopicus*
avibase-550DE745

Herons, Egrets, and Bitterns Ardeidae

2019.1
Eurasian (Great) Bittern *Botaurus stellaris*
avibase-0F42F11A

1:1

→

2026.0
Eurasian Bittern *Botaurus stellaris* avibase-0F42F11A

2019.1
Dwarf Bittern *Ixobrychus sturmii* avibase-87EEBD3E

1:1

→

2026.0
Dwarf Bittern *Botaurus sturmii* avibase-87EEBD3E

2019.1
Little Bittern *Ixobrychus minutus* avibase-7AAD57AC

1:1

→

2026.0
Little Bittern *Botaurus minutus* avibase-7AAD57AC

2019.1
White-backed Night Heron *Gorsachius leuconotus*
avibase-3C12AA44

1:1

→

2026.0
White-backed Night Heron *Calherodius leuconotus*
avibase-3C12AA44

2019.1
Western Reef Egret *Egretta (garzetta) gularis* avibase-DF32B1F9

1:1

→

2026.0
Western Reef Heron *Egretta gularis* avibase-DF32B1F9

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon dimorpha is treated as a subspecies of Egretta garzetta (polytypic, including Australasian immaculata) based on available evidence. Sometimes split as a separate species, or treated as a subspecies of gularis, based largely on the presence of a dark morph, the bare parts color and bill form suggest that dimorpha is better treated as a subspecies of E. garzetta. Furthermore, the name nigripes is considered invalid (nigripes=immaculata) as some syntypes appear to be of hybrid origin, and phenotypic intermediacy suggests widespread intergradation between garzetta and immaculata in the Sundaic region.

2019.1
Little Egret *Egretta garzetta* avibase-F2858F9F
Dimorphic Egret *Egretta (garzetta) dimorpha* avibase-7C15B36B

n:1 →

2026.0
Little Egret *Egretta garzetta* avibase-F2858F9F

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon dimorpha is treated as a subspecies of Egretta garzetta (polytypic, including Australasian immaculata) based on available evidence. Sometimes split as a separate species, or treated as a subspecies of gularis, based largely on the presence of a dark morph, the bare parts color and bill form suggest that dimorpha is better treated as a subspecies of E. garzetta. Furthermore, the name nigripes is considered invalid (nigripes=immaculata) as some syntypes appear to be of hybrid origin, and phenotypic intermediacy suggests widespread intergradation between garzetta and immaculata in the Sundaic region.

2019.1
Striated Heron *Butorides striata* avibase-36DF115B

1:1 →

2026.0
Little Heron *Butorides atricapilla* avibase-7085B8A0

AviList taxonomy decision

Four species are recognized in the Butorides striata complex based on the genomic DNA evidence of Mendales (2023): monotypic B. sundevalli from Galapagos; polytypic B. virescens from North America; monotypic B. striata from South America; and a polytypic Old World B. atricapilla group. While further splits in the B. atricapilla group may be warranted, genetic sampling was too geographically limited to properly assess these; further research needed.

2019.1
Madagascar Pond Heron *Ardeola idae* avibase-EA2C460A

1:1 →

2026.0
Malagasy Pond Heron *Ardeola idae* avibase-EA2C460A

2019.1
Great White Egret *Ardea alba* avibase-49D9148A

1:1 →

2026.0
Great Egret *Ardea alba* avibase-49D9148A

2019.1
Yellow-billed Egret *Egretta intermedia* avibase-C3ABF863

1:1 →

2026.0
Yellow-billed Egret *Ardea brachyrhyncha* avibase-C3ABF863

AviList taxonomy decision

Three monotypic species are recognized in the Ardea intermedia sensu lato complex based on differences in breeding bare parts color, plumage, and morphology, and possibly in display and vocalizations: A. intermedia; A. brachyrhyncha; and A. plumifera. However, genetic data are lacking and further work is needed to corroborate this split.

2019.1
Cattle Egret *Bubulcus ibis* avibase-AB1CB216

1:1 →

2026.0
Western Cattle Egret *Ardea ibis* avibase-AB1CB216

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-0902)) Taxon coromanda is treated as a species separate from Ardea ibis based on consistent differences in proportions and breeding plumage. A comprehensive genetic review is needed. 2025-1187)) Bubulcus is merged into Ardea based on the genomic DNA evidence of Hruska et al. (2023).

Caprimulgiformes

Nightjars and Nighthawks Caprimulgidae

2019.1
Pennant-winged Nightjar *Macrodipteryx vexillarius*
avibase-A526534E

1:1 →

2026.0
Pennant-winged Nightjar *Caprimulgus vexillarius*
avibase-A526534E

2019.1
Standard-winged Nightjar *Macrodipteryx longipennis* avibase-D36F4D98

1:1 →

2026.0
Standard-winged Nightjar *Caprimulgus longipennis*
avibase-D36F4D98

2019.1
Eurasian Nightjar *Caprimulgus europaeus*
avibase-80D4B0FE

1:1 →

2026.0
European Nightjar *Caprimulgus europaeus*
avibase-80D4B0FE

AviList taxonomy decision

Caprimulgus centralasicus is a synonym of C. europaeus based on genetic analysis of the holotype (and sole specimen) (Schweizer et al. 2020a). It probably represents an example of subspecies plumipes but cannot be assigned with confidence based on available morphological and genetic data.

2019.1
Dusky Nightjar *Caprimulgus fraenatus* avibase-E93A0F33

1:1 →

2026.0
Sombre Nightjar *Caprimulgus fraenatus* avibase-E93A0F33

2019.1
Fiery-necked Nightjar *Caprimulgus pectoralis*
avibase-7E3578A2
Fiery-necked Nightjar *Caprimulgus pectoralis*
avibase-62ED1974
Black-shouldered Nightjar *Caprimulgus (pectoralis) nigriscapularis* avibase-AB8E1D95

n:1 →

2026.0
Fiery-necked Nightjar *Caprimulgus pectoralis*
avibase-7E3578A2

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon nigriscapularis is treated as a subspecies of Caprimulgus pectoralis due to overlap in vocalizations (Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1993) and morphometrics (Jackson 2013), and minimal plumage differences (Louette 1990). Limited genetic data confirm monophyly of this group, with nigriscapularis as the most divergent lineage (Han et al. 2010); due to limited genomic sampling and potential mitochondrial DNA introgression, further genetic studies are desirable.

2019.1
Gabon Nightjar *Caprimulgus fossii* avibase-4FD242D0

1:1 →

2026.0
Square-tailed Nightjar *Caprimulgus fossii*
avibase-4FD242D0

Strigiformes

Bay Owls and Barn Owls Tytonidae

2019.1
(African) Grass Owl *Tyto capensis* avibase-B21A37E7

1:1 →

2026.0
African Grass Owl *Tyto capensis* avibase-B21A37E7

2019.1
Barn Owl *Tyto alba* avibase-FEE35F4C

1:1 →

2026.0
Western Barn Owl *Tyto alba* avibase-CFD6F275

AviList taxonomy decision

Tyto alba sensu lato is split into three polytypic species (T. furcata, T. javanica, and T. alba) based on genetics (Aliabadian et al. 2016; Uva et al. 2018) and vocalizations (Robb 2015). Mitochondrial-dominated DNA data (Uva et al. 2018) also placed T. glaucops within the furcata group, while T. nigrobrunnea and T. rosenbergii resolved as part of the javanica group; genomic data are needed to better understand species relationships in this complex.

Owls Strigidae

2019.1
Northern White-faced (Scops) Owl *Ptilopsis leucotis* avibase-E561A180

1:1 →

2026.0
Northern White-faced Owl *Ptilopsis leucotis* avibase-E561A180

2019.1
Southern White-faced (Scops) Owl *Ptilopsis granti* avibase-023D6E38

1:1 →

2026.0
Southern White-faced Owl *Ptilopsis granti* avibase-023D6E38

2019.1
African Long-eared (Abyssinian) Owl *Asio abyssinicus* avibase-250123FB

1:1 →

2026.0
Abyssinian Owl *Asio abyssinicus* avibase-250123FB

2019.1
Spotted Eagle Owl *Bubo africanus* avibase-38E24616
Spotted Eagle Owl *Bubo africanus* avibase-DC8CC91D
Greyish Eagle Owl *Bubo (africanus) cinerascens* avibase-0018A99B

n:n →

2026.0
Greyish Eagle-Owl *Bubo cinerascens* avibase-0018A99B
Spotted Eagle-Owl *Bubo africanus* avibase-DC8CC91D

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon milesi is treated as a monotypic species separate from Bubo africanus (monotypic) based on clear vocal differences, as well as differences in plumage and iris color (Robb 2015; Collar & Boesman 2019).

2019.1
Pel's Fishing-Owl *Scotopelia peli* avibase-034B2A6A

1:1 →

2026.0
Pel's Fishing Owl *Scotopelia peli* avibase-034B2A6A

2019.1
Verreaux's Eagle Owl *Bubo lacteus* avibase-EBD3129B

1:1 →

2026.0
Verreaux's Eagle-Owl *Ketupa lactea* avibase-EBD3129B

Accipitriformes

Kites, Old World Vultures, Eagles, and Hawks Accipitridae

2019.1
African Swallow-tailed Kite *Chelictinia riocourii* avibase-22832FF4

1:1 →

2026.0
Scissor-tailed Kite *Chelictinia riocourii* avibase-22832FF4

2019.1
Black-shouldered (Black-winged) Kite *Elanus caeruleus* avibase-97C47F3E

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-winged Kite *Elanus caeruleus* avibase-97C47F3E

2019.1
African Harrier Hawk (Gymnogene) *Polyboroides typus* avibase-C505EA72

1:1 →

2026.0
African Harrier-Hawk *Polyboroides typus* avibase-C505EA72

2019.1
Lammergeier *Gypaetus barbatus* avibase-81DB7410

1:1 →

2026.0
Bearded Vulture *Gypaetus barbatus* avibase-81DB7410

2019.1
African Cuckoo Hawk *Aviceda cuculoides* avibase-648936C0

1:1 →

2026.0
African Cuckoo-Hawk *Aviceda cuculoides* avibase-648936C0

2019.1
Crested (Oriental) Honey Buzzard *Pernis ptilorhynchus* avibase-1192205B

1:1 →

2026.0
Crested Honey Buzzard *Pernis ptilorhynchus* avibase-1192205B

2019.1
Rüppell’s Vulture *Gyps rueppellii* avibase-76B512B1

1:1 →

2026.0
Rüppell's Vulture *Gyps rueppelli* avibase-76B512B1

2019.1
Ayres’s Hawk Eagle *Hieraaetus ayresii* avibase-7DF00403

1:1 →

2026.0
Ayres's Hawk-Eagle *Hieraaetus ayresii* avibase-7DF00403

2019.1
Cassin's Hawk Eagle *Aquila africana* avibase-51FD3E3C

1:1 →

2026.0
Cassin's Hawk-Eagle *Aquila africana* avibase-51FD3E3C

2019.1
African Hawk Eagle *Aquila spilogaster* avibase-9A418C45

1:1 →

2026.0
African Hawk-Eagle *Aquila spilogaster* avibase-9A418C45

2019.1
African Goshawk *Accipiter tachiro* avibase-35A1472C

1:1 →

2026.0
African Goshawk *Aerospiza tachiro* avibase-35A1472C

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon toussenelii (polytypic) is placed in Aerospiza tachiro (polytypic), based on vocal and behavioral similarities (Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1991, 1993). Recognition of a broader A. tachiro is supported by available mitochondrial DNA data (Breman et al. 2013; Jordaens et al. 2015).

2019.1
Little Sparrowhawk *Accipiter minullus* avibase-CE1CF6FD

1:1 →

2026.0
Little Sparrowhawk *Tachyspiza minulla* avibase-CE1CF6FD

2019.1
Shikra *Accipiter badius* avibase-1A0ECB6E

1:1 →

2026.0
Shikra *Tachyspiza badia* avibase-1A0ECB6E

2019.1
Levant Sparrowhawk *Accipiter brevipes* avibase-8492E4B7

1:1 →

2026.0
Levant Sparrowhawk *Tachyspiza brevipes* avibase-8492E4B7

2019.1
Great (Black) Sparrowhawk *Accipiter melanoleucus* avibase-819AB823

1:1 →

2026.0
Black Sparrowhawk *Astur melanoleucus* avibase-819AB823

2019.1
Black Kite *Milvus migrans* avibase-06D9A2C8
Black Kite *Milvus migrans migrans* avibase-C1C255AA
Yellow-billed Kite *Milvius (migrans) aegyptius* avibase-EE9C6A5E
Eastern Black Kite *Milvius migrans migrans x Milvius migrans lineatus intergrade* avibase-A691B378

n:1 →

2026.0
Black Kite *Milvus migrans* avibase-06D9A2C8

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon aegyptius (polytypic, including parasitus) is treated as conspecific with Milvus migrans pending further research. Although the aegyptius complex is morphologically distinctive, mitochondrial DNA data (Johnson et al. 2005; Andreyenkova et al. 2021) do not recover the group as monophyletic, and geographic patterns do not align with currently recognized subspecies. All taxa are retained within a single species until more comprehensive nuclear or genomic data are available.

2019.1
African Fish Eagle *Haliaeetus vocifer* avibase-A19B0CF4

1:1 →

2026.0
African Fish Eagle *Icthyophaga vocifer* avibase-A19B0CF4

2019.1
Common Buzzard *Buteo buteo* avibase-3C0C325D
(Common) Steppe Buzzard *Buteo buteo (race vulpinus)* avibase-02AD152F

n:1 →

2026.0
Common Buzzard *Buteo buteo* avibase-3C0C325D

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon bannermani (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Buteo buteo (polytypic) based on available evidence. Size-related characters clearly align bannermani with B. buteo, but plumage characters are highly variable and largely uninformative (Kruckenhauser et al. 2004). Conversely, limited mitochondrial DNA data align bannermani with B. rufinus (Clouet & Wink 2000; Kruckenhauser et al. 2004) and there is evidence of genetic introgression within B. buteo and related species (Jowers et al. 2019); further research needed.

Coliiformes

Mousebirds Coliidae

2019.1
Speckled Mousebird *Colius striatus (race kikuyuensis)* avibase-1FDDABDB

1:1 →

2026.0
Speckled Mousebird *Colius striatus* avibase-1FDDABDB

2019.1
White-headed Mousebird *Colius leucocephalus (race turneri)* avibase-ADDB3611

1:1 →

2026.0
White-headed Mousebird *Colius leucocephalus* avibase-ADDB3611

Bucerotiformes

Hoopoes Upupidae

2019.1
Hoopoe *Upupa epops* avibase-FA2F9125
Eurasian Hoopoe *Upupa epops epops* avibase-F4D0DB8E
Eurasian Hoopoe *Upupa epops waibeli* avibase-66F40AD0
African Hoopoe *Upupa (epops) africana* avibase-E4573453

n:1 →

2026.0
Common Hoopoe *Upupa epops* avibase-FA2F9125

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon africana (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Upupa epops (polytypic) based on minor plumage differences, contiguous ranges, and a lack of vocal differences (Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1993).

2019.1
Forest Wood-hoopoe *Phoeniculus castaneiceps* avibase-8CC7216A

Discontinued

Pending EARC

2026.0
None listed

→

Wood Hoopoes and Scimitarbills Phoeniculidae

2019.1
Green Wood-hoopoe *Phoeniculus purpureus*
avibase-28CACA8F

1:1 →

2026.0
Green Wood Hoopoe *Phoeniculus purpureus*
avibase-28CACA8F

2019.1
Violet Wood-Hoopoe *Phoeniculus damarensis*
avibase-76FAC9A5

1:1 →

2026.0
Violet Wood Hoopoe *Phoeniculus damarensis*
avibase-76FAC9A5

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon granti (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Phoeniculus damarensis based on minor differences in plumage. May form a species complex with P. purpureus (Turner 2017); further research required.

2019.1
Black-billed Wood-hoopoe *Phoeniculus somaliensis*
avibase-68A80086

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-billed Wood Hoopoe *Phoeniculus somaliensis*
avibase-68A80086

2019.1
White-headed Wood-hoopoe *Phoeniculus bollei*
avibase-D1FFB474

1:1 →

2026.0
White-headed Wood Hoopoe *Phoeniculus bollei*
avibase-D1FFB474

Hornbills Bucerotidae

2019.1
(Northern) Red-billed Hornbill *Tockus erythrorhynchus* avibase-AF75AC32

1:1 →

2026.0
Northern Red-billed Hornbill *Tockus erythrorhynchus* avibase-AF75AC32

AviList taxonomy decision

Five species are recognized in the Tockus erythrorhynchus complex based on a combination of plumage, bare parts color, vocalizations, genetics (Kemp & Delport 2002; Viseshakul et al. 2011; Gonzalez et al. 2013), and hybrid zone dynamics (Delport et al. 2004): T. erythrorhynchus; T. ruahae; T. kempi; T. rufirostris; and T. damarensis. Mitochondrial DNA data (Gonzalez et al. 2013) suggested that these may divide into two groups: northern erythrorhynchus, kempi, and ruahae and southern rufirostris and damarensis. Further research is needed in areas of parapatry to assess levels of gene flow and a more comprehensive genetic review would be informative.

2019.1
Black-and-white Casqued Hornbill *Bycanistes subcylindricus* avibase-02428AC1

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-and-white-casqued Hornbill *Bycanistes subcylindricus* avibase-02428AC1

Coraciiformes

Rollers Coraciidae

2019.1
Racquet-tailed Roller *Coracias spatulatus* avibase-BB456342

1:1 →

2026.0
Racket-tailed Roller *Coracias spatulatus* avibase-BB456342

2019.1
Rufous-crowned Roller *Coracias naevius*
avibase-2624054E

1:1 →

2026.0
Purple Roller *Coracias naevius* avibase-2624054E

2019.1
Eurasian Roller *Coracias garrulus* avibase-7451A628

1:1 →

2026.0
European Roller *Coracias garrulus* avibase-7451A628

Bee-eaters Meropidae

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Böhm's Bee-eater *Merops boehmi* avibase-30238523

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Ethiopian Bee-eater *Merops lafresnayii* avibase-D0C68FE0

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon lafresnayii is treated as a monotypic species separate from Merops variegatus (polytypic) based on plumage, size, vocalizations, and habitat. Sometimes treated as conspecific with montane M. oreobates but differs in plumage, and possibly vocalizations; occasional reports of intermediacy in some plumage traits (Turner 2010) requires investigation. Genetic data needed to affirm species limits in this complex.

2019.1
Cinnamon-chested Bee-eater *Merops lafresnayii* avibase-B85B93BB

1:1
→

2026.0
Cinnamon-chested Bee-eater *Merops oreobates* avibase-B85B93BB

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon lafresnayii is treated as a monotypic species separate from Merops variegatus (polytypic) based on plumage, size, vocalizations, and habitat. Sometimes treated as conspecific with montane M. oreobates but differs in plumage, and possibly vocalizations; occasional reports of intermediacy in some plumage traits (Turner 2010) requires investigation. Genetic data needed to affirm species limits in this complex.

2019.1
Eurasian Bee-eater *Merops apiaster* avibase-66AA3934

1:1
→

2026.0
European Bee-eater *Merops apiaster* avibase-66AA3934

2019.1
Madagascar Bee-eater *Merops superciliosus* avibase-AC89B8FF

1:1
→

2026.0
Olive Bee-eater *Merops superciliosus* avibase-AC89B8FF

Kingfishers Alcedinidae

2019.1
Semi-collared Kingfisher *Alcedo semitorquata* avibase-F9F5CAB0

1:1
→

2026.0
Half-collared Kingfisher *Alcedo semitorquata* avibase-F9F5CAB0

Piciformes

African Barbets Lybiidae

2019.1
Yellow-billed Barbet *Trachylaemus purpuratus* avibase-75DF194C

1:1
→

2026.0
Eastern Yellow-billed Barbet *Trachylaemus purpuratus* avibase-80BC978E

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon goffinii (polytypic, including togoensis) is treated as a species separate from Trachylaemus purpuratus based on plumage, facial bare parts color, and genetics. Deep mitochondrial DNA divergence (Moyle 2004) supports recognition of an eastern (purpuratus) and western clade but it is unclear if the western sample represented goffinii or togoensis. Pending further genetic research incorporating broader taxon sampling, togoensis is treated as a subspecies of T. goffinii.

2019.1
D'Arnaud's Barbet *Trachyphonus darnaudii*
avibase-1953C1D6
D'Arnaud's Barbet *Trachyphonus darnaudii* avibase-E6D52EF7
Usambiro Barbet *Trachyphonus (darnaudii) usambiro*
avibase-55E9B668

n:1 →

2026.0
D'Arnaud's Barbet *Trachyphonus darnaudii*
avibase-1953C1D6

AviList taxonomy decision

Trachyphonus darnaudii is treated as a single polytypic species based on available evidence. Taxa usambiro and emini sometimes treated as separate species but plumage and morphological differences are relatively modest. Furthermore, although usambiro is vocally distinct, and possibly allopatric, behavioral responses led Short & Horne (1985a) to recognize a single species in this complex. Mitochondrial DNA data are limited (Barker & Lanyon 2000; Moyle 2004; Brown et al. 2008) and a more thorough analysis of morphology, vocalizations and genetics would be informative.

Barbets and Tinkerbirds Rhamphastidae (Lybiinae)

2019.1
Speckled Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus scolopaceus* avibase-EEA161A8

Discontinued
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
None listed

African Barbets Lybiidae

2019.1
Grey-throated (Grey-headed) Barbet *Gymnobucco bonapartei (race cinereiceps)* avibase-95054CA5

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey-throated Barbet *Gymnobucco bonapartei*
avibase-95054CA5

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon cinereiceps (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Gymnobucco bonapartei, as the evidentiary basis for a split is weak. The distributions of bonapartei and cinereiceps appear to be continuous, with a cline of increasing size eastwards, and a broad hybrid zone. Although differences in iris color occur (Chapin 1939) there is no evidence of behavioral, ecological, or genetic differences to support species status.

2019.1
Yellow-rumped Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus bilineatus*
avibase-7749C92B
Lemon-rumped Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus leucolaimus*
avibase-6B28B3A1
Fischer’s (Coastal) Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus fischeri*
avibase-35C11126

n:1 →

2026.0
Yellow-rumped Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus bilineatus*
avibase-7749C92B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon makawai is treated as a synonym of Pogoniulus bilineatus based on analysis of mitochondrial and nuclear DNA (Kirschel et al. 2018). Although plumage differences are striking, the single specimen of makawai is embedded within P. bilineatus suggesting that it is an aberrant color-morph; field observations have also failed to locate additional individuals of makawai (Dowsett et al. 2008).

2019.1
Red-fronted Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus pusillus* avibase-A4CF3B9E

1:1 →

2026.0
Northern Red-fronted Tinkerbird *Pogoniulus uropygialis* avibase-E01F4BD7

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon uropygialis (polytypic, including affinis) is treated as a species separate from Pogoniulus pusillus based on Kirschel et al. (2021).

2019.1
Brown-breasted Barbet *Pogornornis melanopterus*
avibase-724266B4

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown-breasted Barbet *Pogonornis melanopterus*
avibase-724266B4

2019.1		2026.0
Double-toothed Barbet *Pogonornis bidentatus* avibase-439FE608	1:1 →	**Double-toothed Barbet** *Pogonornis bidentatus* avibase-439FE608

2019.1		2026.0
White-headed Barbet *Lybius leucocephalus* avibase-BCA0F974 **White-headed Barbet** *Lybius leucocephalus leucocephalus/albicauda* avibase-408639E6 **Snowy (Brown-and-white) Barbet** *Lybius (leucocephalus) senex* avibase-B91DD3C8	n:1 →	**White-headed Barbet** *Lybius leucocephalus* avibase-BCA0F974

AviList taxonomy decision

The monotypic taxa leucogaster and senex are treated as subspecies of Lybius leucocephalus based on available evidence. Although sometimes split as separate species, plumage differences seem modest, ecologically the taxa are similar, and subspecies senex and albicauda are reported to interbreed (Short & Horne 1985a). Further evidence may show that the geographically isolated subspecies leucogaster warrants separation; further research needed.

Honeyguides Indicatoridae

2019.1		2026.0
Wahlberg's Honeybird *Prodotiscus regulus* avibase-8DB3F1A2	1:1 →	**Brown-backed Honeybird** *Prodotiscus regulus* avibase-8DB3F1A2

2019.1		2026.0
Lesser Honeyguide *Indicator minor* avibase-50F3668C **Lesser Honeyguide** *Indicator minor* avibase-E9ED7248 **Thick-billed Honeyguide** *Iindicator (minor) conirostris* avibase-0AC6CF82	n:1 →	**Lesser Honeyguide** *Indicator minor* avibase-50F3668C

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon conirostris (polytypic, including ussheri) is treated as conspecific with Indicator minor based on the lack of clear-cut ecological, vocal, and plumage differences. Vocalizations appear to be indistinguishable (Short & Horne 1985b), reports of sympatric breeding (Friedmann 1969) have not been substantiated, and genetic data (Sonet et al. 2011) are uninformative; further research needed.

Woodpeckers Picidae

2019.1		2026.0
Fine-banded Woodpecker *Campethera taeniolaema (race hausbergi)* avibase-D0A5FADB	1:1 →	**Fine-banded Woodpecker** *Campethera taeniolaema* avibase-D0A5FADB

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon taeniolaema (polytypic, including hausburgi) is treated as a species separate from Campethera tullbergi based on pronounced differences in underparts plumage, supported by divergence in nuclear and mitochondrial DNA (Fuchs et al. 2017a). Vocalizations are poorly known and a formal bioacoustic analysis may be informative.

2019.1		2026.0
Green-backed Woodpecker *Campethera cailliautii* avibase-BD7C4F70	1:1 →	**Green-backed Woodpecker** *Campethera maculosa* avibase-BD7C4F70

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxa permista and cailliautii (polytypic) are treated as conspecific with Campethera maculosa based on available evidence. Sometimes treated as two or three species based on plumage, taxon permista is only weakly differentiated from maculosa and hybridizes with the phenotypically distinctive cailliautii (Chapin 1952; Prigogine 1987). Divergence in nuclear and mitochondrial DNA (Fuchs et al. 2017a) is modest, and vocalizations of all seem similar, suggesting they are best treated as conspecific pending further research.

2019.1		2026.0
Reichenow’s (Speckle-throated) Woodpecker *Campethera scriptoricauda* avibase-C5585051	1:1 →	**Speckle-throated Woodpecker** *Campethera scriptoricauda* avibase-C5585051

2019.1
Yellow-crested Woodpecker *Chloropicos xantholophus* avibase-2700C97D

1:1 →

2026.0
Yellow-crested Woodpecker *Chloropicus xantholophus* avibase-2700C97D

2019.1
Bearded Woodpecker *Chloropicos namaquus* avibase-77D82F60

1:1 →

2026.0
Bearded Woodpecker *Chloropicus namaquus* avibase-77D82F60

2019.1
Brown-backed Woodpecker *Mesopicus obsoletus* avibase-9FF4EDB5

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown-backed Woodpecker *Dendropicos obsoletus* avibase-9FF4EDB5

2019.1
African Grey Woodpecker *Mesopicus goertae* avibase-E5DF48FC

1:1 →

2026.0
African Grey Woodpecker *Dendropicos goertae* avibase-E5DF48FC

2019.1
Eastern Grey (Grey-headed) Woodpecker *Mesopicus spodocephalus* avibase-902E9F69

1:1 →

2026.0
Eastern Grey Woodpecker *Dendropicos spodocephalus* avibase-902E9F69

Falconiformes

Falcons and Caracaras Falconidae

2019.1
Common Kestrel *Falco tinnunculus* avibase-2DAB45B8
Common Kestrel *Falco tinnunculus tinnunculus* avibase-A76838A0
Rock Kestrel *Falco (tinnunculus) rufescens* avibase-2BD7F8B5

n:1 →

2026.0
Common Kestrel *Falco tinnunculus* avibase-2DAB45B8

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon rupicolus is split from Falco tinnunculus based on genetics (Groombridge et al. 2002; Fuchs et al. 2015) and plumage. Inclusion of rupicolus in F. tinnunculus renders that species polyphyletic based on nuclear and mitochondrial DNA (Fuchs et al. 2015). Taxon rupicolus also shows reduced sexual dichromatism compared to most subspecies, but additional genetic research is needed to resolve the status of other forms within the F. tinnunculus complex, particularly neglectus and alexandri.

2019.1
Red-necked Falcon *Falco chiquera* avibase-6A64EFCB

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-necked Falcon *Falco chicquera* avibase-6A64EFCB

AviList taxonomy decision

The African taxa ruficollis and horsbrughi sometimes are split from Asian nominate Falco chicquera (e.g., del Hoyo & Collar 2014) but the evidentiary basis for a split is considered weak. Differences in plumage are relatively minor and mitochondrial DNA data (Wink & Sauer-Gürth 2000, 2004) are more consistent with subspecies level divergence. Documentation of ecological differences and genomic data might add greater perspective to this proposed split.

2019.1
Peregrine Falcon *Falco peregrinus* avibase-47E58408
Peregrine Falcon *Falco peregrinus* avibase-B46C6125
Barbary Falcon *Falco (peregrinus) pelegrinoides* avibase-A113792C

n:1 →

2026.0
Peregrine Falcon *Falco peregrinus* avibase-47E58408

Psittaciformes

African and New World Parrots Psittacidae

2019.1
Brown (Meyer's) Parrot *Poicephalus meyeri*
avibase-0ECD9D58

1:1
→

2026.0
Meyer's Parrot *Poicephalus meyeri* avibase-0ECD9D58

2019.1
African Orange-bellied Parrot *Poicephalus rufiventris* avibase-69661C7D

1:1
→

2026.0
Red-bellied Parrot *Poicephalus rufiventris*
avibase-69661C7D

Old World Parrots Psittaculidae

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Rose-ringed Parakeet *Psittacula krameri*
avibase-6B1CFC3C

Passeriformes

Lovebirds Psitaculidae

2019.1
Yellow-collared Lovebird *Agapornis personatus*
avibase-4396F4F1

Discontinued
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
None listed

2019.1
Fischer's Lovebird *Agapornis fischeri* avibase-E1EE00F7

Discontinued
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
None listed

2019.1
Hybrid Lovebird *Agapornis fischeri x personatus*
avibase-7B0E2F01

Discontinued
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
None listed

Cuckooshrikes Campephagidae

2019.1
Grey Cuckooshrike *Ceblepyris caesia* avibase-C7B05F46

1:1
→

2026.0
Grey Cuckooshrike *Ceblepyris caesius* avibase-C7B05F46

Bushshrikes and Allies Malaconotidae

2019.1
Marsh Tchagra *Bocagia minuta (race reichenowi)*
avibase-7DCA1C1E

1:1
→

2026.0
Marsh Tchagra *Bocagia minuta* avibase-7DCA1C1E

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon minuta is retained in the monotypic genus Bocagia based on genetics (Fuchs et al. 2012b) and sexual differences in plumage (Harris & Franklin 2000). Nonetheless, it remains closely aligned with the genus Tchagra.

2019.1		2026.0
Three-streaked Tchagra *Tchagra jamesi (race mandanus)* avibase-FA7A6D02	1:1 →	**Three-streaked Tchagra** *Tchagra jamesi* avibase-FA7A6D02

2019.1		2026.0
Grey-headed Bush-Shrike *Malaconotus blanchoti* avibase-641068BB	1:1 →	**Grey-headed Bushshrike** *Malaconotus blanchoti* avibase-641068BB

2019.1		2026.0
Doherty's Bushshrike *Telephorus dohertyi* avibase-0BC36521	1:1 →	**Doherty's Bushshrike** *Telophorus dohertyi* avibase-0BC36521

2019.1		2026.0
Sulphur-breasted Bushshrike *Chlorophoneus sulfureopectus* avibase-F3DCCA8F	1:1 →	**Orange-breasted Bushshrike** *Chlorophoneus sulfureopectus* avibase-F3DCCA8F

2019.1		2026.0
Manda Black Boubou *Laniarius nigerrimus* avibase-E7DC526A	1:1 →	**Black Boubou** *Laniarius nigerrimus* avibase-E7DC526A

2019.1		2026.0
Tropical Boubou *Laniarius aethiopicus* avibase-FBB58997 **Ethiopian Boubou** *Laniarius aethiopicus* avibase-EBC3B53B **Tropical Boubou** *Laniarius (aethiopicus) major/ambiguus* avibase-07F940AA	n:n →	**Ethiopian Boubou** *Laniarius aethiopicus* avibase-EBC3B53B **Tropical Boubou** *Laniarius major* avibase-07F940AA

AviList taxonomy decision

Laniarius major (polytypic) is provisionally split from L. aethiopicus (monotypic) based on available mitochondrial DNA evidence (Nguembock et al. 2008). Broader geographic and genetic sampling is needed to determine species limits in these groups.

2019.1		2026.0
Slate-coloured Boubou *Laniarius funebris* avibase-0868B50D	1:1 →	**Slate-colored Boubou** *Laniarius funebris* avibase-0868B50D

2019.1		2026.0
Sooty Boubou *Laniarius leucorhynchus* avibase-3402C9BB	1:1 →	**Lowland Sooty Boubou** *Laniarius leucorhynchus* avibase-3402C9BB

Wattle-eyes and Batises Platysteiridae

2019.1		2026.0
Jameson's Wattle-eye *Dyaphorophyia jamesoni* avibase-7DC78D7A	1:1 →	**Jameson's Wattle-eye** *Platysteira jamesoni* avibase-7DC78D7A

2019.1		2026.0
Yellow-bellied Wattle-eye *Dyaphorophyia concreta* avibase-3B66D504	1:1 →	**Yellow-bellied Wattle-eye** *Platysteira concreta* avibase-3B66D504

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon ansorgei is retained as a subspecies of Platysteira concreta pending further investigation. Considerable variation in plumage (Harris & Franklin 2000) occurs within P. concreta sensu lato, but a more comprehensive analysis of behavior and vocalizations is required. While mitochondrial DNA analyses have identified some deep divergences within the complex (Njabo et al. 2008; Fuchs et al. 2004; Erard et al. 2019), taxon sampling is incomplete, making any splits premature.

2019.1
Forest Batis *Batis mixta* avibase-D91540DE

1:1 →

2026.0
Short-tailed Batis *Batis mixta* avibase-D91540DE

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon reichenowi is retained as a subspecies of Batis mixta based on genetic evidence and reassessment of plumages following Fjeldså et al. (2006). Plumages within this complex are variable and mitochondrial DNA data showed reichenowi nested within B. mixta; genomic and vocal evidence would be needed to justify a split.

2019.1
Chin-spot Batis *Batis molitor* avibase-C5C38D98

1:1 →

2026.0
Chinspot Batis *Batis molitor* avibase-C5C38D98

2019.1
East Coast (Pale) Batis *Batis soror* avibase-5A58B69A

1:1 →

2026.0
Pale Batis *Batis soror* avibase-5A58B69A

2019.1
Black-headed Batis *Batis minor* avibase-90D0D245

1:1 →

2026.0
Eastern Black-headed Batis *Batis minor* avibase-90D0D245

Vangas, Helmetshrikes, and Allies Vangidae

2019.1
Chestnut-fronted Helmetshrike *Prionops scopifrons (race keniensis)* avibase-E27EEDC5

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-fronted Helmetshrike *Prionops scopifrons* avibase-E27EEDC5

Old World Orioles Oriolidae

2019.1
Western Black-headed Oriole *Oriolus brachyrynchus* avibase-418C7CCB

1:1 →

2026.0
Western Oriole *Oriolus brachyrynchus* avibase-418C7CCB

2019.1
Montane Oriole *Oriolus percivali* avibase-95A2F6E7

1:1 →

2026.0
Mountain Oriole *Oriolus percivali* avibase-95A2F6E7

Drongos Dicruridae

2019.1
Sharpe’s Square-tailed Drongo *Dicrurus sharpei* avibase-84249EE3

1:1 →

2026.0
Sharpe's Drongo *Dicrurus sharpei* avibase-84249EE3

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon sharpei (polytypic, including occidentalis) is treated as a species separate from Dicrurus ludwigii based on analysis of plumage, proportions, and vocalizations (Fishpool et al. 2021), and genetics. Mitochondrial DNA data (Fuchs et al. 2017b, 2018b) do not recover D. ludwigii sensu lato as monophyletic, with sharpei being more closely aligned to D. atripennis. Although a relatively deep mtDNA divergence separates sharpei and occidentalis (Fuchs et al. 2018b) they are treated as conspecific pending further research.

2019.1
Fork-tailed (Common) Drongo *Dicrurus adsimilis* avibase-11FE7313
Glossy-backed (Northern) Drongo *Dicrurus divaricatus* avibase-7763FEC8

n:1 →

2026.0
Fork-tailed Drongo *Dicrurus adsimilis* avibase-11FE7313

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon divaricatus (polytypic, including lugubris) is treated as conspecific with Dicrurus adsimilis based on available evidence. Phenotypic differences are not pronounced (shade of plumage gloss, and length of wing and tail fork), and nuclear DNA data (Fuchs et al. 2018a) recover them as monophyletic. Earlier suggestions of non-monophyly based on a short section of mitochondrial DNA (Fuchs et al. 2017b) appear to be the result of mitochondrial DNA capture in divaricatus west of Lake Chad.

Shrikes Laniidae

2019.1
Geat Grey Shrike *Lanius excubitor* avibase-DB2501EE

Discontinued

Pending EARC

→

2026.0
None listed

2019.1
Turkestan Shrike (Red-tailed) *Lanius phoenicuroides* avibase-EE7915A2

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-tailed Shrike *Lanius phoenicuroides* avibase-EE7915A2

2019.1
Northern White-crowned Shrike *Eurocephalus rueppelli* avibase-866D07A0

1:1 →

2026.0
Northern White-crowned Shrike *Eurocephalus ruppelli* avibase-866D07A0

Crows, Jays, and Magpies Corvidae

2019.1
Cape Rook *Corvus capensis* avibase-562E17AB

1:1 →

2026.0
Cape Crow *Corvus capensis* avibase-562E17AB

2019.1
Dwarf Raven *Corvus edithae* avibase-9DBAAB1D

1:1 →

2026.0
Somali Crow *Corvus edithae* avibase-9DBAAB1D

Fairy Flycatchers Stenostiridae

2019.1
Blue Crested-flycatcher *Elminia longicauda* avibase-56209052

1:1 →

2026.0
African Blue Flycatcher *Elminia longicauda* avibase-56209052

Hyliotas Hyliotidae

2019.1
Forest (Northern) Hyliota *Hyliota (australis) slatini* avibase-F46C1803

1:1 →

2026.0
Southern Hyliota *Hyliota australis* avibase-F840409E

Penduline Tits Remizidae

2019.1
Mouse-coloured Penduline-Tit *Anthoscopus musculus* avibase-6F967270

1:1 →

2026.0
Mouse-colored Penduline Tit *Anthoscopus musculus* avibase-6F967270

2019.1
Penduline Tit *Anthoscopus caroli* avibase-F44BD4BE
Grey Penduline Tit *Anthoscopus caroli* avibase-EE4207D4
Buff-bellied Penduline Tit *Anthoscopus (caroli) sylviella* avibase-6E9DA935

n:1 →

2026.0
Grey Penduline Tit *Anthoscopus caroli* avibase-F44BD4BE

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon sylviella (polytypic) is treated as conspecific with Anthoscopus caroli pending further research. Plumage differences within this complex are variable, vocalizations incompletely studied, and distributions uncertain. Reports of intergrades also need to be assessed (White 1963).

Tits, Chickadees, and Titmice Paridae

2019.1
Pale-eyed (White-shouldered) Black Tit *Melaniparus guineensis* avibase-5C70AA7D

1:1 →

2026.0
White-shouldered Black Tit *Melaniparus guineensis* avibase-5C70AA7D

2019.1
White-bellied Tit *Parus albiventris* avibase-C8880D28

1:1 →

2026.0
White-bellied Tit *Melaniparus albiventris* avibase-C8880D28

2019.1
Dusky Tit *Parus funereus* avibase-5C54F8C9

1:1 →

2026.0
Dusky Tit *Melaniparus funereus* avibase-5C54F8C9

2019.1
Northern Grey Tit *Parus thruppi* avibase-610FFD8E

1:1 →

2026.0
Acacia Tit *Melaniparus thruppi* avibase-610FFD8E

2019.1
Red-throated Tit *Parus fringillinus* avibase-92FDBAF0

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-throated Tit *Melaniparus fringillinus* avibase-92FDBAF0

Larks Alaudidae

2019.1
Fischer's Sparrow Lark *Eremopterix leucopareia* avibase-97D7865F

1:1 →

2026.0
Fischer's Sparrow-Lark *Eremopterix leucopareia* avibase-97D7865F

2019.1
Chestnut-headed Sparrow Lark *Eremopterix signatus* avibase-2F66131B

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-headed Sparrow-Lark *Eremopterix signatus* avibase-2F66131B

2019.1
Chestnut-backed Sparrow Lark *Eremopterix leucotis* avibase-9164F314

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-backed Sparrow-Lark *Eremopterix leucotis* avibase-9164F314

2019.1
Gillett's Lark *Mirafra gilletti* avibase-A3E077E6

1:1 →

2026.0
Gillett's Lark *Calendulauda gilletti* avibase-A3E077E6

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxa gilletti (polytypic) and rufa (polytypic) are placed in the genus Calendulauda, rather than Mirafra, based on the multilocus and genomic DNA of Alström et al. (2023).

2019.1
Fawn-coloured Lark *Calendulauda africanoides* avibase-A990EB0B

1:1 →

2026.0
Fawn-colored Lark *Calendulauda africanoides* avibase-A990EB0B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon alopex (polytypic) is treated as a subspecies of Calendulauda africanoides (polytypic) based on available evidence. Mitochondrial DNA divergence is relatively weak (Alström et al. 2013), as are differences in morphology (Donald & Alström 2024).

2019.1
None listed

New

Pending EARC

→

2026.0
Melodious Lark *Mirafra cheniana* avibase-AB507233

2019.1
Singing Bush Lark *Mirafra cantillans* avibase-6B089785

1:1

→

2026.0
Singing Bush Lark *Mirafra javanica* avibase-5BFC242D

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon cantillans (polytypic) is treated as conspecific with Mirafra javanica (polytypic) based on genetics. Although the two have been recovered as monophyletic clades (Alström et al. 2013), mitochondrial DNA divergence is modest, and diagnostic plumage traits are lacking (Donald & Alström in press).

2019.1
Collared Lark *Mirafra collaris* avibase-D0EAD8A3

1:1

→

2026.0
Collared Lark *Amirafra collaris* avibase-D0EAD8A3

2019.1
Flappet Lark *Mirafra rufocinnamomea* avibase-C49FA9A8

1:1

→

2026.0
Flappet Lark *Amirafra rufocinnamomea* avibase-C49FA9A8

2019.1
Rufous-naped Lark *Mirafra africana (race harterti)* avibase-6A0D6123

1:1

→

2026.0
Rufous-naped Lark *Corypha africana* avibase-EB9CE6A2

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-0218)) Taxon sharpii is treated as a monotypic species separate from Corypha africana based on genetics. Mitochondrial-dominated DNA (Alström et al. 2023) and genome-wide data (Alström et al. 2024) indicate that C. africana sensu lato is not monophyletic, with sharpii forming a deeply divergent clade along with C. hypermetra and C. somalica. Differences in plumage and proportions (Donald & Alström 2024) also support species recognition for sharpii. 2025-1204)) Five new polytypic species are recognized in the genus Corypha based on an integrative study of plumage, morphometrics, vocalizations, and genetics (Alström et al. 2023): C. kidepoensis (including kathangorensis) is treated as a species separate from C. hypermetra (polytypic, including gallarum); C. athi (including harterti); C. nigrescens (including nyikae); C. kabalii (including irwini and malbranti); and C. kurrae (including bamendae, batesi, henrici, and stresemanni) are treated as species separate from C. africana. Taxon irwini is poorly known, and sometimes synonymized with C. africana gomesi. However, based on analysis of specimens (n=2) there are clear differences from a specimen of gomesi (and the type description), and the one irwini that has been analysed genetically was found to be very closely related to kabalii and malbranti (although gomesi has yet to be analysed genetically).

2019.1
Red-winged Lark *Mirafra hypermetra* avibase-BAA83B0C

1:n

→

2026.0
Sentinel Lark *Corypha athi* avibase-D167A312
Red-winged Lark *Corypha hypermetra* avibase-5F213A7D

AviList taxonomy decision

Five new polytypic species are recognized in the genus Corypha based on integrative analysis of morphology (including plumage), vocalizations, and genetics (Alström et al. 2023, 2024): C. kidepoensis (including kathangorensis) is treated as a species separate from C. hypermetra (polytypic, including gallarum); C. athi (including harterti), C. nigrescens (including nyikae), C. kabalii (including irwini and malbranti), and C. kurrae (including bamendae, batesi, henrici, and stresemanni) are treated as species separate from C. africana. Taxon irwinii is poorly known, and sometimes synonymized with C. africana gomesi. However, based on analysis of specimens (n=2) there are clear differences from a specimen of gomesi (and the type description), and the one irwinii that has been analysed genetically was found to be very closely related to kabalii and malbranti (although gomesi has yet to be analysed genetically).

2019.1
Masked Lark *Spizocorys personata (races intensa and mcchesneyi)* avibase-419AEB97

1:1 →

2026.0
Masked Lark *Spizocorys personata* avibase-419AEB97

2019.1
Thekla Lark *Galerida theklae* avibase-5351025C

1:1 →

2026.0
Thekla's Lark *Galerida theklae* avibase-5351025C

2019.1
Red-capped Lark *Calandrella cinerea (race williamsi)* avibase-FCDA4F09

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-capped Lark *Calandrella cinerea* avibase-FCDA4F09

2019.1
Somali Short-toed Lark *Alaudala somalica (includes the race athensis)* avibase-61CECCA7

1:1 →

2026.0
Somali Short-toed Lark *Alaudala somalica* avibase-61CECCA7

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon athensis (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Alaudala somalica (polytypic) based on available evidence. Plumage differences are slight, vocal differences have not been documented, and genetic data are lacking.

Longbills, Crombecs, and Allies Macrosphenidae

2019.1
Northern Crombec *Sylvietta brachyura* avibase-7542C6F1
Northern Crombec *Sylvietta brachyura* avibase-0C8B9FA4
White-bellied (Eastern) Crombec *Sylvietta (brachyura) leucopsis* avibase-406E1A4D

n:1 →

2026.0
Northern Crombec *Sylvietta brachyura* avibase-7542C6F1

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon leucopsis is retained as a subspecies of Sylvietta brachyura based on inconsistent plumage differences and evidence for dialectal variation in vocalizations; further research is required to determine species limits.

Cisticolas and Allies Cisticolidae

2019.1
Turner’s Eremomela *Eremomela turneri (race turneri)* avibase-7D340BF9

1:1 →

2026.0
Turner's Eremomela *Eremomela turneri* avibase-7D340BF9

2019.1
Miombo (Pale) Wren Warbler *Calamonastes undosus* avibase-1E7CADC2

1:1 →

2026.0
Miombo Wren-Warbler *Calamonastes undosus* avibase-1E7CADC2

2019.1
Grey-backed Camaroptera *Camaroptera brachyura* avibase-DC456636

1:1 →

2026.0
Bleating Camaroptera *Camaroptera brachyura* avibase-DC456636

AviList taxonomy decision

The polytypic brevicaudata group is retained in Camaroptera brachyura based on present evidence. Sometimes split based on plumage and habitat differences, the grey-backed brevicaudata group and green-backed brachyura group are vocally similar (Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1980), and hybridize in areas of contact (White 1962; Zimmerman et al. 2001). Available mitochondrial DNA data (Nguembock et al. 2007) identified deep divergences between brevicaudata, harterti, and brachyura, but further research is needed to define species limits in this group.

2019.1
Taita Apalis *Apalis (thoracica) fuscigularis* avibase-D5549C6D

1:1 →

2026.0
Taita Apalis *Apalis fuscigularis* avibase-D5549C6D

2019.1
Yellow-breasted Apalis *Apalis flavida* avibase-E70F9747
Yellow-breasted Apalis *Apalis flavida (race pugnax)* avibase-CA02C9A1
Brown-tailed Apalis *Apalis (flavida) flavocincta* avibase-8C13DA6F

n:1 →

2026.0
Yellow-breasted Apalis *Apalis flavida* avibase-E70F9747

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon flavocincta (polytypic) is retained as a subspecies of Apalis flavida pending further research. Proposed differences in habitat, plumage, and vocalizations are not sufficient to warrant a split in this geographically variable complex; the possibility of intergradation between flavocincta and adjacent forms also requires investigation (Ash & Atkins 2009).

2019.1
Black-headed Apalis *Apalis melanocephala (race nigrodorsalis)* avibase-4FE76868

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-headed Apalis *Apalis melanocephala* avibase-4FE76868

2019.1
Karamoja Apalis *Apalis karamojae* avibase-D029B521

1:1 →

2026.0
Maasai Apalis *Apalis stronachi* avibase-DCA0028B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon stronachi is treated as a monotypic species separate from Apalis karamojae based on differences in plumage, vocalizations, and behavior (Nalwanga et al. 2016; Boesman & Collar 2023).

2019.1
Red-winged Warbler *Prinia erythropterus* avibase-C67FD539

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-winged Prinia *Prinia erythroptera* avibase-C67FD539

2019.1
Red-fronted (Red-faced) Warbler *Prinia rufifrons* avibase-D8177CEC

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-fronted Prinia *Prinia rufifrons* avibase-D8177CEC

2019.1
Rock-loving Cisticola *Cisticola aberrans* avibase-2C8B24B6

1:1 →

2026.0
Rock-loving Cisticola *Cisticola aberrans* avibase-AB6AE581

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon bailunduensis is treated as a monotypic species separate from Cisticola aberrans (polytypic, including emini) based on vocalizations coupled with morphological and ecological differences (del Hoyo & Collar 2016).

2019.1
Wailing Cisticola *Cisticola lais* avibase-9AEEFA09

1:1 →

2026.0
Lynes's Cisticola *Cisticola distinctus* avibase-52B4F230

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon distinctus is treated as a monotypic species separate from Cisticola lais on the basis of divergence in mitochondrial DNA, with distinctus recovered as sister to C. subruficapilla (Davies 2014). Apparent differences in plumage, song, and habitat have been reported, but the two taxa are very similar in plumage and reports of vocal differences are conflicting (Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1993; Zimmerman et al. 2001; Stevenson & Fanshawe 2020); further research needed to confirm this split.

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Ethiopian Cisticola *Cisticola lugubris* avibase-3DF3F9B9

2019.1
Levaillant's Cisticola *Cisticola tinniens (race oreophilus)* avibase-F936B680

1:1 →

2026.0
Levaillant's Cisticola *Cisticola tinniens* avibase-F936B680

2019.1
Short-winged (Siffling) Cisticola *Cisticola brachypterus (race kericho)* avibase-FBDCA962

1:1 →

2026.0
Short-winged Cisticola *Cisticola brachypterus* avibase-FBDCA962

Reed Warblers and Allies Acrocephalidae

2019.1
Eastern Olivaceous Warbler *Hippolais pallida* avibase-BAE527A2

1:1 →

2026.0
Eastern Olivaceous Warbler *Iduna pallida* avibase-BAE527A2

2019.1
Dark-capped (African) Yellow Warbler *Iduna natalensis* avibase-EBBD09CA

1:1 →

2026.0
African Yellow Warbler *Iduna natalensis* avibase-EBBD09CA

2019.1
African Reed Warbler *Acrocephalus baeticatus* avibase-34E27C2A
Eurasian Reed Warbler *Acrocephalus scirpaceus* avibase-3F0EE474

n:1 →

2026.0
Common Reed Warbler *Acrocephalus scirpaceus* avibase-3F0EE474

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon baeticatus (polytypic) is treated as conspecific with Acrocephalus scirpaceus (polytypic) based on relatively low differentiation in vocalizations (Dowsett-Lemaire & Dowsett 1987), morphology, and genetics (Olsson et al. 2016; Pavia et al. 2018) across the geographic range of this complex. Furthermore, mitochondrial DNA data (Olsson et al. 2016) do not provide strong support for a two-species treatment; further research warranted.

Grasshopper Warblers, Grassbirds, and Allies Locustellidae

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Bamboo Warbler *Locustella alfredi* avibase-A630DB2C

2019.1
Fan-tailed Grassbird *Schoenicola brevirostris* avibase-2470FC01

1:1 →

2026.0
Fan-tailed Grassbird *Catriscus brevirostris* avibase-2470FC01

2019.1
Highland (Northern) Rush Warbler *Bradypterus centralis* avibase-D6A69E06

1:1 →

2026.0
Highland Rush Warbler *Bradypterus centralis* avibase-D6A69E06

Swallows Hirundinidae

2019.1
Plain Martin *Riparia paludicola* avibase-D2854489

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown-throated Martin *Riparia paludicola* avibase-D2854489

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon cowani is treated as a monotypic species separate from Riparia paludicola based on a relatively deep genomic DNA divergence (Brown 2019), supported by plumage and vocalizations. However, a comprehensive review of morphological, vocal, and genetic variation across the R. paludicola complex would be informative.

2019.1
Rock Martin *Ptyonoprogne fuligula* avibase-47DA0258

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-throated Rock Martin *Ptyonoprogne rufigula* avibase-A85102D3

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-1041)) Three polytypic species are recognized in the Ptyonoprogne fuligula complex based on a combination of plumage, size, vocalizations, and genetics (Brown 2019): P. fuligula (including anderssoni and pretoriae); P. rufigula (including bansoensis and pusilla); and P. obsoleta (all remaining subspecies). Further research to assess gene flow in areas of contact would be informative. 2025-1211)) Taxon pusilla is treated as a subspecies of Ptyonoprogne rufigula, rather than of P. obsoleta, based on biogeography and plumage (Ash & Atkins 2009).

2019.1
Common House Martin *Delichon urbicum* avibase-30FEC6BE

1:1 →

2026.0
Western House Martin *Delichon urbicum* avibase-30FEC6BE

2019.1
Rufous-chested Swallow *Cecropis semirufa* avibase-958F4A5E

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-breasted Swallow *Cecropis semirufa* avibase-958F4A5E

2019.1
Red-rumped Swallow *Cecropis daurica* avibase-F72A871F
Red-rumped Swallow *Cecropis daurica emini* avibase-94F9F616
Red-rumped Swallow *Cecropis daurica rufula* avibase-B4967714

n:n →

2026.0
African Red-rumped Swallow *Cecropis melanocrissus* avibase-91315CD4
European Red-rumped Swallow *Cecropis rufula* avibase-B4967714

AviList taxonomy decision

Five species are recognized in the Cecropis daurica complex based on a combination of plumage, vocalizations, and evidence from mitochondrial (Sheldon et al. 2005) and genomic DNA data (Brown 2019; Schield et al. 2024): monotypic C. hyperythra based on plumage and vocalizations; monotypic C. badia based on plumage, size, and parapatry with populations of daurica; polytypic C. daurica involving a merger of most populations of temperate-migratory daurica and tropical Asian striolata based on clinality in plumage and genetic paraphyly; monotypic C. rufula based on plumage, genetics, and a zone of parapatry with populations of C. daurica; and polytypic C. melanocrissus based on plumage and genetics. A comprehensive review of this complex integrating formal bioacoustic analyses, broad genomic sampling, and phenotypic variation, is desirable.

Leaf Warblers Phylloscopidae

2019.1
Wood Warbler *Rhadina sibilatrix* avibase-572C4C7F

1:1 →

2026.0
Wood Warbler *Phylloscopus sibilatrix* avibase-572C4C7F

2019.1
Yellow-throated Woodland Warbler *Seicercus ruficapilla* avibase-F6B77E64

1:1 →

2026.0
Yellow-throated Woodland Warbler *Phylloscopus ruficapilla* avibase-F6B77E64

2019.1
Brown Woodland Warbler *Seicercus umbrovirens* avibase-E22B8495

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown Woodland Warbler *Phylloscopus umbrovirens* avibase-E22B8495

2019.1
Uganda Woodland Warbler *Seicercus budongoensis* avibase-132E0773

1:1 →

2026.0
Uganda Woodland Warbler *Phylloscopus budongoensis* avibase-132E0773

Bulbuls Pycnonotidae

2019.1
Sombre (Zanzibar) Greenbul *Andropadus importunus* avibase-79A45DAF

1:1 →

2026.0
Sombre Greenbul *Andropadus importunus* avibase-79A45DAF

2019.1
Slender-billed Greenbul *Stelgidillas gracilirostris (race percivali)* avibase-5D82C13B

1:1 →

2026.0
Slender-billed Greenbul *Stelgidillas gracilirostris* avibase-5D82C13B

2019.1
Red-tailed Bristlebill *Bleda syndactyla* avibase-5A94FEAE

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-tailed Bristlebill *Bleda syndactylus* avibase-5A94FEAE

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Yellow-eyed Bristlebill *Bleda ugandae* avibase-1D9175EA

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon ugandae is treated as a species separate from Bleda notatus based on a combination of mitochondrial-dominated DNA data (Huntley & Voelker 2016), plumage, morphometrics, and vocal differences.

2019.1
Mountain Greenbul *Arizelocichla nigriceps* avibase-54A902B5
Olive-breasted Mountain Greenbul *Arizelocichla (nigriceps) kikuyuensis* avibase-1EEE86B8
Eastern Mountain Greenbul *Arizelocichla nigriceps nigriceps* avibase-FC523946

n:n →

2026.0
Kikuyu Mountain Greenbul *Arizelocichla kikuyuensis* avibase-1EEE86B8
Black-headed Mountain Greenbul *Arizelocichla nigriceps* avibase-FC523946

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon kikuyuensis is treated as a species separate from Arizelocichla nigriceps based on plumage, vocalizations, and genetics. Although plumage differences are obvious, information from mitochondrial DNA (Shakya & Sheldon 2017; De Santis et al. 2018) is restricted to short fragments, and formal bioacoustic analyses are lacking; further research would be informative.

2019.1
Stripe-cheeked Greenbul *Arizelocichla milanjensis* avibase-4996833A

1:1 →

2026.0
Olive-headed Greenbul *Arizelocichla striifacies* avibase-9A80B57C

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon striifacies (polytypic, including olivaceiceps) is treated as a species separate from Arizelocichla milanjensis based on available evidence. Sometimes split into 3 species (A. milanjensis, A. striifacies and A. olivaceiceps) but plumage differences support a 2-species treatment with milanjensis, the most distinctive taxon, separated at the species level. Genetic data are fragmentary but mitochondrial DNA (Shakya & Sheldon 2017) supports separation of striifacies from milanjensis. Nevertheless, a comprehensive genetic study and investigation of contact zones is needed to confirm species limits in this group.

2019.1
Yellow-throated Greenbul (Leaflove) *Atimastillas flavicollis* avibase-C73137EA

1:1 →

2026.0
Pale-throated Greenbul *Atimastillas flavigula* avibase-04E77EEF

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon flavigula (polytypic, including soror) is treated as a species separate from Atimastillas flavicollis based on plumage and vocalizations. Although plumages are geographically variable they show an abrupt transition, with an apparent lack of intergradation, where their ranges approach. Available genetic data are fragmentary (Moyle & Marks 2006; Johansson et al. 2007; Fregin et al. 2012a) and comparative data lacking; further research needed.

2019.1
Ansorge's Greenbul *Eurillas ansorgei (race kavirondensis)* avibase-0EA5F2E1

1:1 →

2026.0
Ansorge's Greenbul *Eurillas ansorgei* avibase-0EA5F2E1

2019.1
Tiny Greenbul *Phyllastrephus debilis* avibase-FA137697

1:1 →

2026.0
Lowland Tiny Greenbul *Phyllastrephus debilis* avibase-FA137697

2019.1
Cabanis's Greenbul *Phyllastrephus cabanisi* avibase-24F71192
Cabanis's Greenbul *Phyllastrephus cabanisi* avibase-3029C547
Placid Greenbul *Phyllastrephus (cabanisi) placidus* avibase-CF1DDF4E

n:1 →

2026.0
Cabanis's Greenbul *Phyllastrephus cabanisi* avibase-24F71192

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon placidus is treated as a subspecies of Phyllastrephus cabanisi (polytypic, including sucosus) based on available evidence. Sometimes treated as separate species based on morphology (Dowsett 1972), taxon sucosus has been shown to be intermediate in size between the two (Dowsett-Lemaire 1990; Dowsett & Dowsett-Lemaire 1993), and they lack significant vocal, behavioral, and ecological differences. Genetic data are fragmentary (Johansson et al. 2007; De Santis et al. 2018), and largely uninformative; further research needed.

2019.1
Common Bulbul *Pycnonotus barbatus* avibase-6ABDB635
Common Bulbul *Pycnonotus barbatus* avibase-ADC1F0C9
Dodson's Bulbul *Pycnonotus (barbatus) dodsoni* avibase-B2F86107

n:1 →

2026.0
Common Bulbul *Pycnonotus barbatus* avibase-6ABDB635

AviList taxonomy decision

The Pycnonotus barbatus complex is treated as a single polytypic species based on available evidence. Sometimes split into four species (P. barbatus, P. somaliensis, P. dodsoni, and P. tricolor); however, plumage differences are minor, intermediate phenotypes and potential hybrids have been reported (e.g., Turner & Pearson 2015), and vocal differences appear negligible. Although ad hoc mitochondrial DNA data are available for some taxa (Sorenson & Payne 2001; Moyle & Marks 2006; Fuchs et al. 2009, 2018c; Dejtaradol et al. 2016; Huntley & Voelker 2016) a comprehensive genetic review of this complex is lacking; further research needed.

Sylviid Warblers and Allies Sylviidae

2019.1
Blackcap *Sylvia atricapilla* avibase-61F9065B

1:1 →

2026.0
Eurasian Blackcap *Sylvia atricapilla* avibase-61F9065B

2019.1
Barred Warbler *Sylvia nisoria* avibase-1EA60B94

1:1 →

2026.0
Barred Warbler *Curruca nisoria* avibase-1EA60B94

2019.1
Banded Parisoma *Sylvia boehmi (race marsabit)* avibase-982C918E

1:1 →

2026.0
Banded Parisoma *Curruca boehmi* avibase-982C918E

2019.1
Lesser Whitethroat *Sylvia curruca* avibase-0DCD05BE

1:1 →

2026.0
Lesser Whitethroat *Curruca curruca* avibase-0DCD05BE

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon minula (polytypic, including margelanica) and taxon althaea (monotypic) are treated as conspecific with Curruca curruca pending further research. Analyses of mitochondrial DNA (Olsson et al. 2013a), genome-wide DNA data (Abdilzadeh et al. 2023), and stable isotopes (Votier et al. 2016) suggest that this complex should be treated as more than one species, but more comprehensive genomic and vocal analyses are needed to better define species limits.

2019.1
Brown Parisoma *Sylvia lugens* avibase-16FEF081

1:1 →

2026.0
Brown Parisoma *Curruca lugens* avibase-16FEF081

2019.1
Common Whitethroat *Sylvia communis*
avibase-14AFBA82

1:1 →

2026.0
Common Whitethroat *Curruca communis*
avibase-14AFBA82

White-eyes, Yuhinas, and Allies Zosteropidae

2019.1
Common Scrub White-eye *Zosterops flavilateralis*
avibase-F80D69C2

1:1 →

2026.0
Pale White-eye *Zosterops flavilateralis* avibase-F80D69C2

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Green White-eye *Zosterops stuhlmanni* avibase-33C35018

AviList taxonomy decision

The Zosterops senegalensis complex is split into five species based mostly on Martins et al. (2020): polytypic Z. senegalensis; polytypic Z. stuhlmanni; polytypic Z. anderssoni; polytypic Z. kasaicus; and monotypic Z. stenocricotus. Mitochondrial DNA data consistently recover members of the Z. senegalensis sensu lato complex as non-monophyletic (Melo et al. 2011; Cox et al. 2014; Martins et al. 2020) leading to the recognition of five species. However, geographic sampling is limited and supporting information from genomic data, which may provide an additional perspective on species limits in this complex, are lacking.

2019.1
None listed

New
Pending EARC
→

2026.0
Broad-ringed White-eye *Zosterops eurycricotus*
avibase-A23B8E7A

2019.1
Montane (Heuglin's) White-eye *Zosterops poliogastrus (race kulalensis)* avibase-BF3D3E26

1:1 →

2026.0
Kafa White-eye *Zosterops kaffensis* avibase-52C60399

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon kaffensis (polytypic, including kulalensis) is treated as a species separate from Zosterops poliogastrus based mostly on mitochondrial DNA evidence (Martins et al. 2020), and apparent parapatry between nominate kaffensis and poliogastrus. Although sometimes split into three species, the status of the isolated taxon kulalensis remains uncertain as it is somewhat intermediate in plumage between poliogastrus and kaffensis, but larger than both; further research needed.

2019.1
Northern Yellow White-eye *Zosterops senegalensis*
avibase-EAC8528E

1:1 →

2026.0
Northern Yellow White-eye *Zosterops senegalensis*
avibase-86F34425

AviList taxonomy decision

The Zosterops senegalensis complex is split into five species based mostly on Martins et al. (2020): polytypic Z. senegalensis; polytypic Z. stuhlmanni; polytypic Z. anderssoni; polytypic Z. kasaicus; and monotypic Z. stenocricotus. Mitochondrial DNA data consistently recover members of the Z. senegalensis sensu lato complex as non-monophyletic (Melo et al. 2011; Cox et al. 2014; Martins et al. 2020) leading to the recognition of five species. However, geographic sampling is limited and supporting information from genomic data, which may provide an additional perspective on species limits in this complex, are lacking.

Ground Babblers and Allies Pellorneidae

2019.1
Grey-breasted Illadopsis *Illadopsis distans* avibase-A14D3117

1:1 →

2026.0
Tanzanian Illadopsis *Illadopsis distans* avibase-A14D3117

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon distans is treated as a monotypic species separate from Illadopsis rufipennis (polytypic) based on strong vocal differences (Boesman 2016eee), supported by divergence in some plumage traits, and genetics with mitochondrial DNA data recovering I. rufipennis as non-monophyletic (Fjeldså & Bowie 2021). Taxon puguensis is treated as a synonym of distans based on a lack of evidence of distinctness.

Laughingthrushes and Allies Leiothrichidae

2019.1
Black-lored Babbler *Turdoides sharpei* avibase-7350FE4C
Black-lored Babbler *Turdoides sharpei sharpei* avibase-42C9B9B1
Black-lored (Mt. Kenya) Babbler *Turdoides (sharpei) vepres* avibase-BE76A224

n:1 →

2026.0
Black-lored Babbler *Turdoides sharpei* avibase-7350FE4C

Spotted Creepers Salpornithidae

2019.1
Spotted Creeper *Salpornis salvadori* avibase-A51A5F84

1:1 →

2026.0
African Spotted Creeper *Salpornis salvadori* avibase-A51A5F84

Oxpeckers Buphagidae

2019.1
Red-billed Oxpecker *Buphagus erythrorhynchus* avibase-7471E71D

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-billed Oxpecker *Buphagus erythroryncha* avibase-7471E71D

AviList taxonomy decision

The original spelling was Tanagra erythroryncha, but the species was soon moved into the genus Buphagus, and many modern sources have emended the original spelling to "erythrorhynchus" (with an -rh). In 2023, by some measures, the usage of the -rh spelling was roughly an order of magnitude higher than the usage of the original -r spelling, but by other measures, it was only ~4 times higher, which is not considered as a prevailing usage by most practitioners, hence arguing in favor of the retention of the original -r spelling. Additionally, erythroryncha is not an adjective but a poorly formed noun, and its ending can therefore not be adjusted according to the gender of the genus. Therefore, the original spelling "erythroryncha" is retained.

Rhabdornis, Starlings, and Mynas Sturnidae

2019.1
Rose-coloured Starling *Pastor roseus* avibase-24208346

1:1 →

2026.0
Rosy Starling *Pastor roseus* avibase-24208346

2019.1
Abbott's Starling *Poeoptera femoralis* avibase-1350773F

1:1 →

2026.0
Abbott's Starling *Arizelopsar femoralis* avibase-1350773F

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon sharpii is placed in the monospecific genus Pholia and taxon femoralis is placed in a monospecific Arizelopsar based on morphology and genetics. Sometimes placed in Poeoptera, but mitochondrial DNA divergences among these three genera are relatively deep (Lovette & Rubenstein 2007).

2019.1
Kenrick's Starling *Poeoptera kenricki (race bensoni)* avibase-295B9665

1:1 →

2026.0
Kenrick's Starling *Poeoptera kenricki* avibase-295B9665

2019.1
White-crowned Starling *Lamprotornis albicapillus (race horrensis)* avibase-A77D4A77

1:1 →

2026.0
White-crowned Starling *Lamprotornis albicapillus* avibase-A77D4A77

Thrushes and Allies Turdidae

2019.1
Spotted Ground Thrush *Zoothera guttata* avibase-60A39CF9

1:1

2026.0
Spotted Ground Thrush *Geokichla guttata* avibase-60A39CF9

2019.1		2026.0
	→	
2019.1 **Abyssinian Ground Thrush** *Zoothera piaggiae* avibase-C54DCA26	1:1 →	2026.0 **Abyssinian Ground Thrush** *Geokichla piaggiae* avibase-C54DCA26
2019.1 **Orange Ground Thrush** *Zoothera gurneyi (race raineyi)* avibase-45C55FDE	1:1 →	2026.0 **Orange Ground Thrush** *Geokichla gurneyi* avibase-45C55FDE
2019.1 **Northern Olive (Abyssinian) Thrush** *Turdus abyssinicus* avibase-428DA7CD	1:1 →	2026.0 **Abyssinian Thrush** *Turdus abyssinicus* avibase-428DA7CD
2019.1 **African Bare-eyed Thrush** *Turdus tephronotus* avibase-A0DC8E87	1:1 →	2026.0 **Bare-eyed Thrush** *Turdus tephronotus* avibase-A0DC8E87

Chats, Old World Flycatchers, and Allies Muscicapidae

2019.1		2026.0
2019.1 **Bearded Scrub Robin** *Cercotrichas quadrivirgata* avibase-92908926	1:1 →	2026.0 **Bearded Scrub Robin** *Tychaedon quadrivirgata* avibase-92908926
2019.1 **Rufous Bush Chat** *Cercotrichas galactotes* avibase-B68BD0D2	1:1 →	2026.0 **Rufous-tailed Scrub Robin** *Cercotrichas galactotes* avibase-B68BD0D2
2019.1 **Pale Flycatcher** *Bradornis pallidus* avibase-FA03A965 **Pale Flycatcher** *Bradornis pallidus pallidus* avibase-060AF4FA **Bafirawar's Flycatcher** *Bradornis (pallidus) bafirawari* avibase-CAC5AD6C	n:1 →	2026.0 **Pale Flycatcher** *Agricola pallidus* avibase-FA03A965
2019.1 **Grey Tit-flycatcher (Lead-coloured Flycatcher)** *Fraseria plumbea* avibase-5EA2B90C	1:1 →	2026.0 **Grey Tit-Flycatcher** *Fraseria plumbea* avibase-5EA2B90C
2019.1 **African Dusky Flycatcher** *Muscicapa adusta (race marsabit)* avibase-6E95C4A9	1:1 →	2026.0 **African Dusky Flycatcher** *Muscicapa adusta* avibase-6E95C4A9
2019.1 **White-starred Robin** *Pogonocichla stellata (race macarthuri)* avibase-230A0342	1:1 →	2026.0 **White-starred Robin** *Pogonocichla stellata* avibase-230A0342
2019.1 *None listed*	New Pending EARC →	2026.0 **Yellow-breasted Forest Robin** *Stiphrornis mabirae* avibase-2455B82B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxa pyrrholaemus (monotypic) and mabirae (polytypic, including sanghensis) are treated as species separate from Stiphrornis erythrothorax (polytypic, including gabonensis, dahomeyensis, inexpectatus, and xanthogaster) based on plumage and genetics (Beresford & Cracraft 1999; Schmidt et al. 2008; Voelker et al. 2013, 2017). Sometimes treated as five species, mitochondrial-dominated DNA data have revealed three deeply diverged lineages within this complex (Voelker et al. 2017) consistent with a 3-species treatment. Further bioacoustic and genetic research is needed to better define distributional and taxonomic limits within this complex.

2019.1		2026.0
Brown-chested Alethe *Chaemaetylas poliocephala (race akeleyae)* avibase-8B7A6FE9	1:1 →	**Brown-chested Alethe** *Chamaetylas poliocephala* avibase-8B7A6FE9
Blue-shouldered Robin Chat *Cossypha cyanocampter* avibase-9616C96E	1:1 →	**Blue-shouldered Robin-Chat** *Cossypha cyanocampter* avibase-9616C96E
Rüppell's Robin Chat *Cossypha semirufa* avibase-53EABB81	1:1 →	**Rüppell's Robin-Chat** *Cossypha semirufa* avibase-53EABB81
White-browed Robin Chat *Cossypha heuglini* avibase-16BD42DD	1:1 →	**White-browed Robin-Chat** *Cossypha heuglini* avibase-16BD42DD
Red-capped Robin Chat *Cossypha natalensis* avibase-3846F8A8	1:1 →	**Red-capped Robin-Chat** *Cossypha natalensis* avibase-3846F8A8
Snowy-headed Robin Chat *Cossypha niveicapilla* avibase-BB05D1FC	1:1 →	**Snowy-crowned Robin-Chat** *Cossypha niveicapilla* avibase-BB05D1FC
Spotted Morning (Spotted Palm) Thrush *Cichladusa guttata* avibase-345658E9	1:1 →	**Spotted Palm Thrush** *Cichladusa guttata* avibase-345658E9
Cape Robin Chat *Caffrornis caffra* avibase-A38BABE1	1:1 →	**Cape Robin-Chat** *Dessonornis caffer* avibase-A38BABE1
Grey-winged Robin *Sheppardia polioptera* avibase-25C26AB9	1:1 →	**Grey-winged Robin-Chat** *Sheppardia polioptera* avibase-25C26AB9

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon polioptera (polytypic) is placed in Sheppardia based on genetics (Beresford 2003; Sangster et al. 2010; Zhao et al. 2023). Although previously placed in Cossypha, multilocus data (Zhao et al. 2023) provide strong support for this alternative placement.

2019.1		2026.0
Irania *Irania gutturalis* avibase-73BD4B29	1:1 →	**White-throated Robin** *Irania gutturalis* avibase-73BD4B29

2019.1
Semi-collared Flycatcher *Ficedula semitorquata*
avibase-BE56C141

1:1 →

2026.0
Semicollared Flycatcher *Ficedula semitorquata*
avibase-BE56C141

2019.1
Pied Flycatcher *Ficedula hypoleuca* avibase-6E352E18

1:1 →

2026.0
European Pied Flycatcher *Ficedula hypoleuca*
avibase-6E352E18

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon speculigera is treated as a monotypic species separate from Ficedula hypoleuca (polytypic) based on phenotypic and genetic (Sætre et al. 2001a, 2001b) evidence, including genomic data (Nater et al. 2015).

2019.1
None listed

New

Pending EARC

→

2026.0
Siberian Stonechat *Saxicola maurus* avibase-3380CFC5

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-0171)) Taxon stejnegeri is treated as conspecific with Saxicola maurus pending further research. Although mitochondrial DNA data (Zink et al. 2009; Illera et al. 2008) indicate the presence of deep divergences within the Asian stonechats, not all taxa have been sampled. Furthermore, unsampled taxa have senior scientific names and may be closely related to stejnegeri; consequently, the split of stejnegeri is considered premature; genomic data required. 2025-0172)) Saxicola torquatus is treated as three species based on available evidence: S. maurus (Asian stonechats, polytypic); S. torquatus (African stonechats, polytypic); and S. rubicola (European stonechats, polytypic). Genomic (Van Doren et al. 2017) and mitochondrial DNA data (Zink et al. 2009; Illera et al. 2008) do not recover S. torquatus sensu lato as monophyletic, with S. dacotiae embedded within it. A more comprehensive taxonomic review of this complex is required given the ecological and phenotypic similarities among these species.

2019.1
Common Stonechat *Saxicola torquatus* avibase-CF2E9674

1:1 →

2026.0
African Stonechat *Saxicola torquatus* avibase-CF2E9674

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-0170)) Taxon sibilla is treated as conspecific with Saxicola torquatus (polytypic) pending further research. Mitochondrial DNA data (Woog et al. 2008) revealed a relatively deep divergence between sibilla and S. t. axillaris, but taxon sampling is incomplete, and historical introgression has not been ruled out; a comprehensive genetic review based on genomic DNA is required. 2025-0172)) Saxicola torquatus is treated as three species based on available evidence: S. maurus (Asian stonechats, polytypic); S. torquatus (African stonechats, polytypic); and S. rubicola (European stonechats, polytypic). Genomic (Van Doren et al. 2017) and mitochondrial DNA data (Zink et al. 2009; Illera et al. 2008) do not recover S. torquatus sensu lato as monophyletic, with S. dacotiae embedded within it. A more comprehensive taxonomic review of this complex is required given the ecological and phenotypic similarities among these species.

2019.1
Moorland (Alpine) Chat *Pinarochroa sordida*
avibase-8EB0AB41

1:1 →

2026.0
Moorland Chat *Pinarochroa sordida* avibase-8EB0AB41

2019.1
Northern Anteater Chat *Myrmecocichla aethiops*
avibase-E09F7223

1:1 →

2026.0
Anteater Chat *Myrmecocichla aethiops* avibase-E09F7223

2019.1
None listed

New

Pending EARC

→

2026.0
Arnot's Chat *Myrmecocichla arnotti* avibase-535524BE

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon collaris (monotypic) is treated as a subspecies of Myrmecocichla arnotti (polytypic) pending further research. Although mitochondrial DNA data (Glen et al. 2011) indicate a modest divergence, geographic sampling is limited. Additional data are needed to support a split.

2019.1
Black-eared Wheatear *Oenanthe hispanica* avibase-DF26171F

1:1 →

2026.0
Eastern Black-eared Wheatear *Oenanthe melanoleuca* avibase-DF26171F

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon melanoleuca (monotypic) is treated as a species separate from Oenanthe hispanica (monotypic) based on genetics (Aliabadian et al. 2012; Kakhki et al. 2018; Schweizer et al. 2019a, b; Zhao et al. 2023).

2019.1
Heuglin's Wheatear *Oenanthe heuglini* avibase-6ADB636C

1:1 →

2026.0
Heuglin's Wheatear *Oenanthe heuglinii* avibase-6ADB636C

AviList taxonomy decision

2025-0161)) Taxon frenata is treated as a monotypic species separate from Oenanthe bottae (monotypic) based on modest plumage differences. Forming a complex with O. heuglinii and O. isabellina (Zhao et al. 2023), plumage differences among African species are relatively weak and mitochondrial DNA divergence is modest (Zhao et al. 2023). Although genetic data for O. bottae are lacking, its plumage is considered the most distinct, prompting recognition of frenata as a separate species. Further research is needed and may result in a taxonomic revision of this complex. 2025-N030)) The earliest mention of the name has the spelling heuglinii, attributed to a work by von Heuglin (1869: 346-7), wherein the latter author credited Hartlaub & Finsch for the description.

2019.1
Familiar (Red-tailed) Chat *Oenanthe familiaris* avibase-CD8DEBE3

1:1 →

2026.0
Familiar Chat *Oenanthe familiaris* avibase-CD8DEBE3

Dapple-throat and Allies Modulatricidae

2019.1
Grey-chested Kakamega (Thrush-babbler) *Kakamega poliothorax* avibase-FC1BE879

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey-chested Babbler *Kakamega poliothorax* avibase-FC1BE879

Spiderhunters and Sunbirds Nectariniidae

2019.1
Grey-chinned Sunbird *Anthreptes rectirostris* avibase-71EF2ACB

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey-chinned Sunbird *Anthreptes tephrolaemus* avibase-35A2CCDF

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon tephrolaemus is treated as a species separate from Anthreptes rectirostris based on abrupt differences in male plumage across a well-documented zoogeographical barrier, supported by vocalizations (Dowsett-Lemaire & Dowsett 2014). Genetic data would be informative.

2019.1
Collared Sunbird *Anthodiaeta collaris* avibase-1611F295

1:1 →

2026.0
Collared Sunbird *Hedydipna collaris* avibase-1611F295

2019.1
Pygmy Sunbird *Hedydipna platyura* avibase-B0E7740F

1:1 →

2026.0
Pygmy Sunbird *Hedydipna platura* avibase-B0E7740F

2019.1
Amani Sunbird *Anthodiaeta pallidigaster* avibase-0B4F3AA2

1:1 →

2026.0
Amani Sunbird *Hedydipna pallidigaster* avibase-0B4F3AA2

2019.1
Mouse-coloured Sunbird *Cyanomitra veroxii* avibase-C1CBA33A

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey Sunbird *Cyanomitra veroxii* avibase-C1CBA33A

AviList taxonomy decision

Use of "veroxii" is the correct original spelling and clearly represents an unusual but intended Latinization of the genitive of the name "Verreaux". Any other spelling is an unjustified emendation.

2019.1
Golden-winged Sunbird *Drepanorhynchus reichenowi (race lathburyi)* avibase-D33D2F6D

1:1 →

2026.0
Golden-winged Sunbird *Drepanorhynchus reichenowi* avibase-D33D2F6D

2019.1
Beautiful Sunbird *Cinnyris pulchellus* avibase-00D5E1C6

1:n →

2026.0
Beautiful Sunbird *Cinnyris pulchellus* avibase-718A3B70
Gorgeous Sunbird *Cinnyris melanogastrus* avibase-375BAF53

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon melanogastrus is treated as a species separate from Cinnyris pulchellus based on an abrupt transition in male plumage (belly color), the absence of intermediate phenotypes, and apparent vocal differences (Boesman 2016m). However, a formal bioacoustic analysis, and evidence from genetics or behavior, would be informative.

2019.1
Shining Sunbird *Cinnyris habessinicus* avibase-C6D0CB7E

1:1 →

2026.0
Abyssinian Sunbird *Cinnyris habessinicus* avibase-688582BF

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon hellmayri (polytypic, including kinneari) is treated as a species separate from Cinnyris habessinicus based on differences in male and female plumages, larger size, and reportedly different vocalizations (Shirihai & Svensson 2018). Formal bioacoustic and genetic analyses would be informative.

Weavers and Allies Ploceidae

2019.1
Grosbeak Weaver *Amblyospiza albifrons* avibase-C7708C70

1:1 →

2026.0
Thick-billed Weaver *Amblyospiza albifrons* avibase-C7708C70

2019.1
White-browed Sparrow Weaver *Plocepasser mahali* avibase-94C71DF6

1:1 →

2026.0
White-browed Sparrow-Weaver *Plocepasser mahali* avibase-94C71DF6

2019.1
Chestnut-crowned Sparrow Weaver *Plocepasser superciliosus* avibase-2C504059

1:1 →

2026.0
Chestnut-crowned Sparrow-Weaver *Plocepasser superciliosus* avibase-2C504059

2019.1
Donaldson Smith's Sparrow Weaver *Plocepasser donaldsoni* avibase-5011E123

1:1 →

2026.0
Donaldson Smith's Sparrow-Weaver *Plocepasser donaldsoni* avibase-5011E123

2019.1
Taveta Golden Weaver *Ploceus castaneiceps* avibase-2379E3EB

1:1 →

2026.0
Taveta Weaver *Ploceus castaneiceps* avibase-2379E3EB

2019.1
Weyn’s Weaver *Ploceus weynsi* avibase-341298B9

1:1

2026.0
Weyns's Weaver *Ploceus weynsi* avibase-341298B9

→

2019.1		2026.0
Kilifi (Clarke's) Weaver *Ploceus golandi* avibase-2A2CC7B3	1:1 →	**Kilifi Weaver** *Ploceus golandi* avibase-2A2CC7B3
Yellow-backed Weaver *Ploceus melanocephalus* avibase-19D053B3	1:1 →	**Black-headed Weaver** *Ploceus melanocephalus* avibase-19D053B3
Black Bishop *Euplectes gierowii* avibase-CC7862AF **Northern Black Bishop** *Euplectes gierowii gierowii* avibase-8C0F6D53 **Southern Black Bishop** *Euplectes (gierowii) friederichseni* avibase-83340007	n:1 →	**Black Bishop** *Euplectes gierowii* avibase-CC7862AF
Yellow-mantled Widowbird *Euplectes macroura* avibase-F5E0EA0D **Yellow-mantled Widowbird** *Euplectes macroura macroura* avibase-4167B45D **Yellow-shouldered Widowbird** *Euplectes (macroura) macrocercus* avibase-4ED105CA	n:1 →	**Yellow-mantled Widowbird** *Euplectes macroura* avibase-F5E0EA0D
Red-collared Widowbird *Euplectes ardens* avibase-26618AA1	1:n →	**Red-cowled Widowbird** *Euplectes laticauda* avibase-6A1F6033 **Red-collared Widowbird** *Euplectes ardens* avibase-26618AA1

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon laticauda (polytypic, including suahelicus) is split from Euplectes ardens (monotypic) based on differences in plumage, molts, and tail length. A genetic analysis dominated by mitochondrial DNA data places E. l. suahelicus as a divergent sister lineage to E. ardens (Prager et al. 2008) in support of this treatment; as nominate E. laticauda was not included in the analysis, further genetic work is desirable.

2019.1		2026.0
Long-tailed Widowbird *Euplectes progne (race delamerei)* avibase-3153FE22	1:1 →	**Long-tailed Widowbird** *Euplectes progne* avibase-3153FE22
Red-headed Weaver *Anaplectes rubriceps* avibase-BE3C45B5	1:n →	**Red Weaver** *Anaplectes jubaensis* avibase-ECE36984 **Red-headed Weaver** *Anaplectes rubriceps* avibase-4D19099B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon jubaensis is treated as a monotypic species separate from Anaplectes rubriceps (polytypic) based on plumage differences. Taxon leuconotos is retained as a subspecies of A. rubriceps based on plumage similarities and the presence of a broad zone of hybridization between them.

Whydahs and Indigobirds Viduidae

2019.1		2026.0
Parasitic Weaver *Anomalospiza imberbis* avibase-C97A5C39	1:1 →	**Cuckoo-finch** *Anomalospiza imberbis* avibase-C97A5C39

2019.1
Eastern Paradise Whydah *Vidua paradisaea* avibase-ACF0F1A2

1:1 →

2026.0
Long-tailed Paradise Whydah *Vidua paradisaea* avibase-ACF0F1A2

Munias, Parrotfinches, Waxbills, and Allies Estrildidae

2019.1
Grey-headed Silverbill *Odontospiza griseicapilla* avibase-7D6F12FE

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey-headed Silverbill *Spermestes griseicapilla* avibase-7D6F12FE

2019.1
Black-and-white Mannikin *Spermestes bicolor* avibase-E358EC8A
Black-and-white Mannikin *Spermestes bicolor* avibase-21C4CE6A
Red-backed Mannikin *Spermestes (bicolor) nigriceps* avibase-A02BCF5E

n:1 →

2026.0
Black-and-white Mannikin *Spermestes bicolor* avibase-E358EC8A

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon nigriceps (polytypic) is treated as conspecific with Spermestes bicolor (polytypic) based on available evidence. Reports of parapatry have not been confirmed and genetic data are limited (Arnaiz-Villena et al. 2009; Olsson & Alström 2020); further research needed.

2019.1
Green-backed Twinspot *Mandingoa nitidula* avibase-1A6B766A

1:1 →

2026.0
Green Twinspot *Mandingoa nitidula* avibase-1A6B766A

2019.1
White-breasted Negrofinch *Nigrita fusconotus* avibase-F3B46894

1:1 →

2026.0
White-breasted Nigrita *Nigrita fusconotus* avibase-F3B46894

2019.1
Grey-headed Negrofinch *Nigrita canicapillus* avibase-B15F4C49

1:1 →

2026.0
Grey-headed Nigrita *Nigrita canicapillus* avibase-B15F4C49

2019.1
Black-faced Waxbill *Estrilda erythronotos* avibase-842FF43C

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-faced Waxbill *Brunhilda erythronotos* avibase-842FF43C

2019.1
Black-cheeked Waxbill *Estrilda charmosyna* avibase-50BF77FB

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-cheeked Waxbill *Brunhilda charmosyna* avibase-50BF77FB

2019.1
African Quailfinch *Ortygospiza atricollis* avibase-8E5252EB

1:1 →

2026.0
Quailfinch *Ortygospiza atricollis* avibase-8E5252EB

2019.1
Black-bellied Seed-cracker *Pyrenestes ostrinus* avibase-2CC91390

1:1 →

2026.0
Black-bellied Seedcracker *Pyrenestes ostrinus* avibase-2CC91390

2019.1
Peter's Twinspot *Hypargos niveoguttatus* avibase-50490520

1:1 →

2026.0
Red-throated Twinspot *Hypargos niveoguttatus* avibase-50490520

Snowfinches and Old World Sparrows Passeridae

2019.1 **Yellow-spotted Petronia** *Gymnoris pyrgita* avibase-FCD72CEE	1:1 →	2026.0 **Yellow-spotted Bush Sparrow** *Gymnoris pyrgita* avibase-FCD72CEE
2019.1 **Grey-headed Sparrow** *Passer griseus* avibase-E10D0809 **Northern Grey-headed Sparrow** *Passer griseus ugandae* avibase-2F9F81C9	n:1 →	2026.0 **Northern Grey-headed Sparrow** *Passer griseus* avibase-E10D0809
2019.1 **Swainson’s Sparrow** *Passer (griseus) swainsonii* avibase-F375B25B	1:1 →	2026.0 **Swainson's Sparrow** *Passer swainsonii* avibase-F375B25B
2019.1 **Parrot-billed Sparrow** *Passer (griseus) gongonensis* avibase-DB4998D1	1:1 →	2026.0 **Parrot-billed Sparrow** *Passer gongonensis* avibase-DB4998D1
2019.1 **Swahili Sparrow** *Passer (griseus) suahelicus* avibase-2B55E679	1:1 →	2026.0 **Swahili Sparrow** *Passer suahelicus* avibase-2B55E679
2019.1 **Rufous Sparrow** *Passer cordofanicus* avibase-A61F55E3 **Kenya Rufous Sparrow** *Passer (cordofanicus) rufocinctus* avibase-DBAB527C **Shelley’s Sparrow** *Passer (cordofanicus) shelleyi* avibase-126E0CFA	n:n →	2026.0 **Kenya Sparrow** *Passer rufocinctus* avibase-DBAB527C **Shelley's Sparrow** *Passer shelleyi* avibase-126E0CFA

Wagtails and Pipits Motacillidae

2019.1 **Yellow Wagtail** *Motacilla flava* avibase-5983D677	1:1 →	2026.0 **Western Yellow Wagtail** *Motacilla flava* avibase-5983D677
2019.1 **Rosy-breasted Longclaw** *Macronyx ameliae* avibase-70129CB1	1:1 →	2026.0 **Rosy-throated Longclaw** *Macronyx ameliae* avibase-70129CB1
2019.1 **Grassland Pipit** *Anthus cinnamomeus* avibase-0D7CC717	1:1 →	2026.0 **African Pipit** *Anthus cinnamomeus* avibase-0D7CC717
2019.1 **Bush Pipit** *Anthus caffer* avibase-4C7B3D81	1:1 →	2026.0 **Bushveld Pipit** *Anthus caffer* avibase-4C7B3D81

Finches, Euphonias, and Allies Fringillidae

2019.1 **Western Citril** *Crithagra (citrinelloides) frontalis* avibase-5108E1D3	1:1 →	2026.0 **Western Citril** *Crithagra frontalis* avibase-5108E1D3

2019.1		2026.0
Southern (Grey-faced) Citril *Crithagra (citrinelloides) hyposticta* avibase-C978ABCC	1:1 →	**Southern Citril** *Crithagra hyposticta* avibase-C978ABCC
Black-throated Seedeater *Crithagra atrogularis* avibase-D12CDD0F	1:1 →	**Black-throated Canary** *Crithagra atrogularis* avibase-D12CDD0F
Reichenow's Seedeater [Yellow-rumped] *Crithagra reichenowi* avibase-69EB514A	1:1 →	**Reichenow's Seedeater** *Crithagra reichenowi* avibase-69EB514A
Northern Grosbeak Canary *Crithagra donaldsoni* avibase-0CEB2DA6	1:1 →	**Northern Grosbeak-Canary** *Crithagra donaldsoni* avibase-0CEB2DA6
Southern Grosbeak Canary *Crithagra buchanani* avibase-F3618305	1:1 →	**Southern Grosbeak-Canary** *Crithagra buchanani* avibase-F3618305
Thick-billed Seedeater *Crithagra burtoni (race albifrons)* avibase-8E8B3DB9	1:1 →	**Thick-billed Seedeater** *Crithagra burtoni* avibase-8E8B3DB9

Old World Buntings Emberizidae

2019.1		2026.0
Golden-breasted Bunting *Fringillaria flaviventris* avibase-D1C1A026	1:1 →	**Golden-breasted Bunting** *Emberiza flaviventris* avibase-D1C1A026
Somali Bunting *Fringillaria poliopleura* avibase-72386016	1:1 →	**Somali Bunting** *Emberiza poliopleura* avibase-72386016
Brown-rumped Bunting *Fringillaria affinis* avibase-BB11EE7F	1:1 →	**Brown-rumped Bunting** *Emberiza affinis* avibase-BB11EE7F
Striolated Bunting *Fringillaria striolata* avibase-CDF4A106	1:1 →	**Striolated Bunting** *Emberiza striolata* avibase-CDF4A106
None listed	New Pending EARC →	**Gosling's Bunting** *Emberiza goslingi* avibase-17E7F90B

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon septemstriata is treated as conspecific with Emberiza tahapisi, although its status as a valid taxon remains unresolved. The single specimen included in the genetic study of Olsson et al. (2013b) had the plumage of tahapisi but the mitochondrial DNA of E. goslingi; further research needed.

2019.1	1:1	2026.0
Cinnamon-breasted Bunting *Fringillaria tahapisi* avibase-0C571D99	→	**Cinnamon-breasted Bunting** *Emberiza tahapisi* avibase-0C571D99

AviList taxonomy decision

Taxon septemstriata is treated as conspecific with Emberiza tahapisi, although its status as a valid taxon remains unresolved. The single specimen included in the genetic study of Olsson et al. (2013b) had the plumage of tahapisi but the mitochondrial DNA of E. goslingi; further research needed.